

NYCHA - REES: A Closer Look at the Referral System

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INTRODUCTION

PART 1

1.2. REES

REES (Resident Economic Empowerment and Sustainability) is a NYCHA department with the aim of connecting NYCHA residents with partnering non-governmental organizations, which in turn provide residents with opportunities and resources that will help them to thrive financially.

REES utilizes a zone model to geographically organize its work across all developments in the city. There are 15 zones in total that work to connect the residents in each zone to nearby partners and their services. These services address many different needs in the areas of adult education, workforce development, financial empowerment and business development. The service providers, referred to as *partners*, are organizations that work locally. For residents' optimal convenience, there are partners in each zones that offer their services. Residents are not limited to the services in their zones, but are also

⁸ CBCNY. "Cleaning House", <https://cbcny.org/research/cleaning-house>

⁹ NYCHA. "Nycha Metrics",

https://eapps.nycha.info/NychaMetrics/Charts/PublicHousingChartsTabs/?section=public_housing&tab=tab_repairs

¹⁰ New York City. "New York City Government Poverty Measure 2005-2016 An Annual Report From the Mayor", April 2018, pg. 14

welcome to travel to other areas for a service that may not be available in their immediate surrounding. REES carefully screens each organization and creates a *memorandum of understanding* (MOU) before establishing their partnership. NYCHA benefits through its REES partnerships because it can thus impact more residents than if it had provided these services directly through NYCHA. At the same time, REES partners benefit from having their services marketed to the network of NYCHA developments, thus increasing their organization's impact. A zone coordinator works as a liaison in their specific zones to coordinate between residents, partners, and other stakeholders.¹¹ The zone model provides a sustainable blueprint to help empower residents and their communities by bringing resources directly to them.

Zone 5

This report takes a look at Zone 5 and its local partners. The zone encompasses the northern Brooklyn neighborhoods of Williamsburg, Bedford-Stuyvesant, and Bushwick. The zone works with 9 partners who help to serve the residents of 30 developments in the area. Zone partners include: Bedford Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation, Jobs Plus (a Restoration service), Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow, St. Nick's Alliance, Brooklyn Educational Opportunity Center, Brooklyn Cooperative, Bridge Street Development Corporation, RiseBoro's Community Empowerment Center, and NYC Small Business Solutions. The zone coordinator for this area is Evelyn Melendez. Beyond acting as the main liaison for all inquiries for this report, she helps to connect the 27,919 residents to the high quality services of the zone partners. According to the *NYCHA Year end dataset* for 2016, almost 48% of households in this zone are below poverty and 47.2% of families are working.¹² Of the residents, almost 60% are between the ages of 18-61 and non-disabled, while 53.3% of those same residents are employed.

¹³

A key component for service providers and the zones they serve are the memorandums of understanding (MOU) that the providers agree to sign before they commit to a partnership with REES. MOUs outline the level of commitment and goals that partners promise to fulfill. Initially, partners sign a MOU for one year as a trial period and if the partnership becomes successful the MOU can be renewed for about three years. If partners fall back in their quality of service provisions, they can be put back onto a trial period.

¹¹ NYCHA. "The Zone Model", <http://opportunitynycha.org/what-is-rees/zone-model/>

¹² NYCHA. "Transparency & Reports", <http://www1.nyc.gov/site/nycha/about/reports.page>

¹³ *ibidem*

PROJECT AIM & MAIN QUESTIONS

PART 2

A central aspect of NYCHA-REES is their partnerships with local non-governmental organizations. There are two types of partnerships: "recruitment" and "referral". Recruitment implies the promotion and recruitment for partners' classes and other events by REES. Through the referral system, REES connects residents with the partnering organizations, so that the latter can provide the services the residents need to improve their economic and financial situation.

Our aim is to systematically assess REES's partnership as far as the referral system is concerned. This means analyzing the numbers of residents who are referred and subsequently getting the services they need from the partners by **analyzing the referral process** and the **actors** involved.

Questions connected to this are:

- Which channels of referrals are most effective, which are less so and why?
- Which factors prevent the successful referrals and a successful service provision?
- How sustainable is the success and how can the partnerships be improved?

METHODOLOGY & ANALYTICAL APPROACH

PART 3

Our research includes a quantitative as well as a qualitative approach to assess the efficiency of the referral model. Using quantitative data provided by REES, we assessed the efficiency of the system by looking at the different steps and different actors within the referral system. For this purpose, we analyzed specifically how many referrals were made and by whom, the number of appointments residents make at partner organizations and the number of residents who attended the service they are offered.

The data we received from REES was anonymized and entailed information from 2013 to 2018. Initially we tried to compile data from all the years available, but during the process we learned about inconsistencies, which were largely due to a migration of the data from two servers to one in 2017. As a result, we decided to use only data from the year 2016. The data is from the most recent time period and not affected by the data breach. Thus, this report is an analysis of data based on NYCHA residents in Zone 5 in 2016. The 2016 data has some key differences compared to current data. The number of developments according to our data increased from 24 in 2016 to 30 in 2018. Thus, the number of residents has also changed since 2016.

In addition to the quantitative approach, we also included a qualitative part to complement our quantitative findings. We conducted our fieldwork from February to April 2018, gathering detailed information concerning the subjects' experiences and reflections on the partnership that cannot be extracted from quantitative data. The fieldwork consisted of participant observation in stakeholder meetings (NYCHA, REES and partners) and informal interviews. Throughout the project, the Zone 5 Coordinator, Evelyn Melendez provided us with a wealth of information and also coordinated all the meetings, and interviews with the partners of our interests. We spoke with her off and online through in-person meetings in school, on interview sites, and through e-mail and web conferences. These interactions also served as informal interviews at times, which its contents were used in our analyses.

Interviews

Besides our fieldwork, we chose three partnering organizations - St Nick's Alliance Employment Assistance, Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow and Bedford Stuyvesant Restoration - due to their performance according to the data and interviewed some of their front-line staff. The three REES partners chosen for interviews were picked on the basis of the data we collected regarding their referrals and service appointments. Each partner represents a low-performing, mid-range performing, and high-performing partner in terms of appointments. Many similarities and unique challenges were discovered upon comparing the interview findings from all three partners. The interviews partly underlined our quantitative findings and complemented them by giving us more detailed information about the partners' experiences in their work with residents.

Formally, we conducted three interviews in April, each with different partners. As mentioned above, these partners were specifically chosen because of their different range in performance. All of the interviewees handled *frontline* tasks in addition to other duties, which means that they are the first to get in contact with the residents once they are referred to them. Their specific positions allowed us to get a better understanding of particular causes of patterns we have noticed in our quantitative referral data. The interviews were open-ended, in-depth interviews that followed an interview guideline (see Appendix 4). Each interview lasted approximately 45 minutes to an hour and half. We found the qualitative data acquired through the interviews to closely reflect the quantitative data we have analyzed throughout the month of March. Moreover, it complimented our quantitative findings in giving us more detailed information on the partners' experiences with residents in the process between referral and attending an appointment.

Zone 5 Partners

St. Nicks Alliance (*St Nicks*) has over 40 years of experience working with North Brooklyn communities on issues such as workforce development, elder care, affordable housing, youth and education. Their services include job coaching and skilled training programs, with training for construction work being a very popular service. St. Nicks was chosen with regards to their employment assistance programs. St. Nicks data ranked them as our average performing partner. Almost 43% of referrals made to St. Nick's for employment assistance were scheduled with an appointment. Of those REES referrals, only 6% had attended their appointments.

Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow (*OBT*) is another organization that offers services in job placement and assistance. OBT also has educational offerings such as English classes for speakers of other languages and high school equivalency preparation. Although OBT has almost 35 years of serving the Bronx, Brooklyn and Queens boroughs, OBT's referral data suggested it as a below average partner. Although OBT had the third highest amount of referrals after Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration and St. Nicks Alliance, only 9% of these referred REES clients, scheduled an appointment. From those, none (0%) attended their appointments.

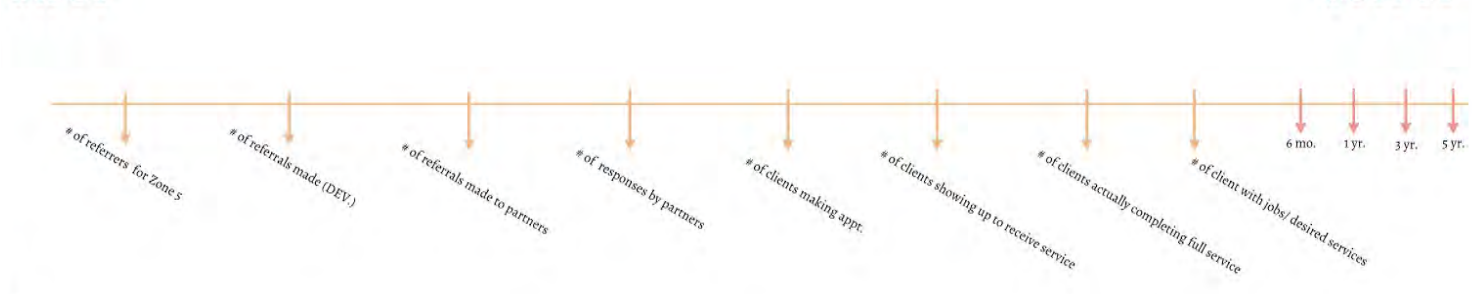
Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation (*Restoration*) is the oldest organization interviewed, with almost 50 years of service to the communities of central Brooklyn. Like the other organizations, Restoration offers employment assistance programs as well as a myriad of other services from community health initiatives to annual tax preparation. Restoration has grown to be a great resource to its community. As a REES partner, Restoration is high-performing and has the best data regarding their referrals. About 54% of referrals directed to Restoration made appointments for their services and 98% of those who made an appointment also attended to receive their services.

THE REFERRAL PROCESS: TIMELINE

PART4

INPUT

OUTPUT



At the beginning of the project, we formed a **linear chain timeline** for Zone 5 to assess the numbers in the pipeline, from the numbers of referrals made, all the way down to a person having a sustainable job, or appropriate training or education up to five years down the line.

With the **quantitative data** given to us, we were only able to assess **5 sections** out of the 11.

The 5 sections were (1. # of referrals for Zone 5; 2. # of referrals made by developments; 3. # of referrals by partners; 5. # of clients showing up to receive service; 6. # of clients actually completing full service).

ANALYSIS

PART 5

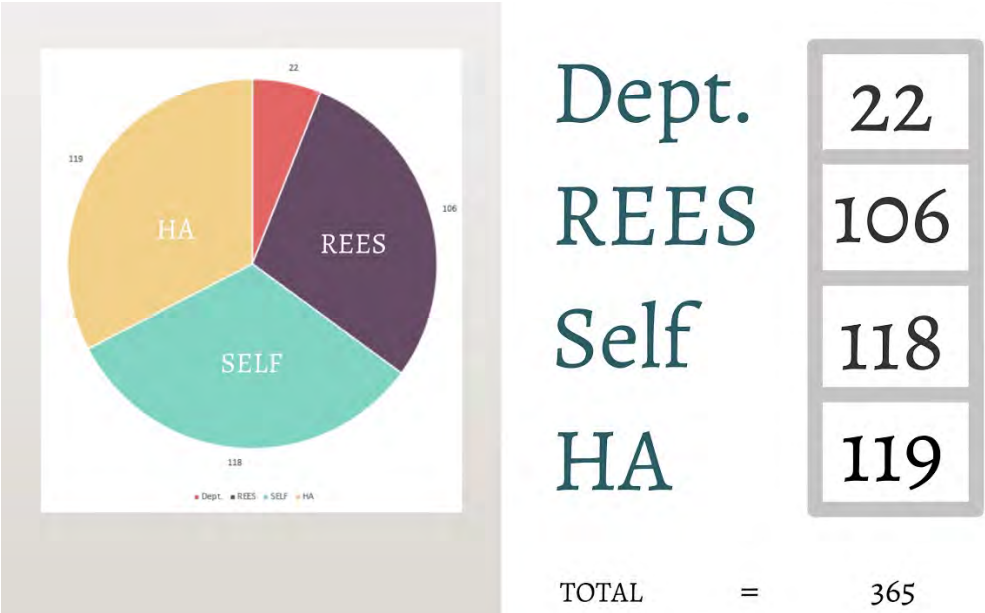
*Our analysis falls into **three** main chapters that are organized along the timeline we developed at the beginning of the project. The three main steps are **Referral making**, **Appointment making**, and **Appointment attendance**.*

5.1. Referrals

The data analysis shows that in Zone 5 in 2016, in total **365 residents** were referred to REES partners through the referral system. This represents **2%** of the 16,726 non-disabled NYCHA residents between the age of 18 and 61.

- Approximately 33% of referrals were made by **housing managers**
- Approximately 32% of referrals were made by **residents**
- Approximately 30% of referrals were made by **REES**

Referrals made by the three main actors are relatively equally distributed.

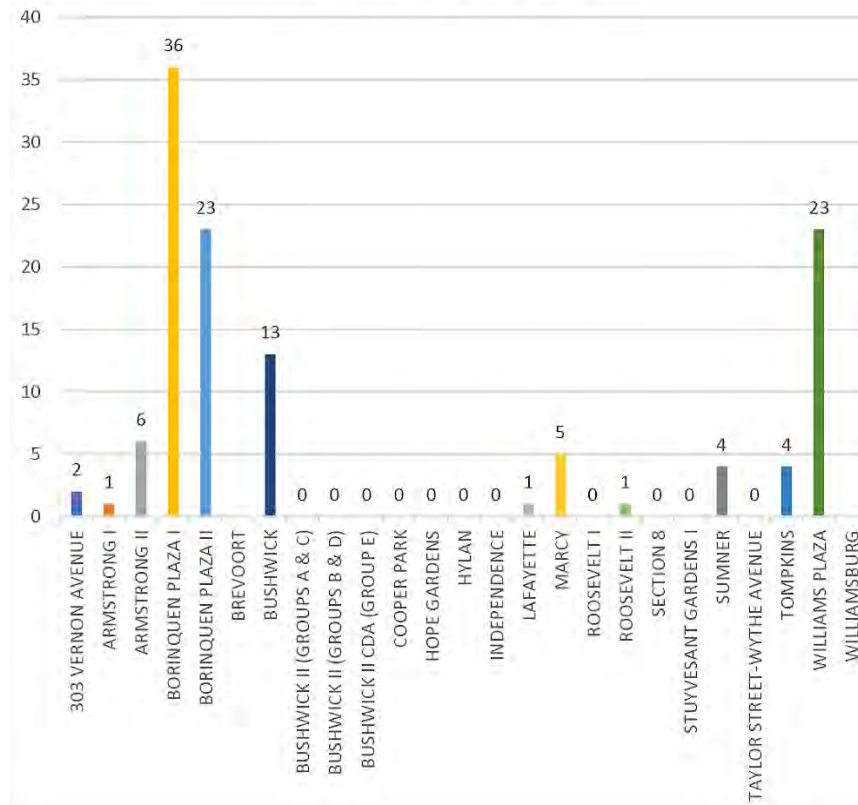


For REES staff, especially for the zone coordinators, being in the middle-man position and promoting the referral system to housing managers and partners, referring residents is part of their work. Their referrals are important for the functioning of the partnership.

In what follows, we will focus on the referrals made by the housing assistants¹⁴ and the self-referrals - complementing the data with findings from our qualitative analysis.

¹⁴ We use 'housing assistants' and 'housing managers' interchangeably as this was also the case during our fieldwork

Housing Managers



Housing managers are a contact person NYCHA residents can turn to if they need help for a myriad of reasons. Their kiosks are in the developments (in some cases, there is one kiosk for several developments), which is accessible to the residents. In some cases, housing assistants (HA) are NYCHA residents themselves. While the HA are mainly responsible for rent collection, they also receive a referral training by REES so that they can navigate the online form to refer residents to partners.

The data reveals that referrals made by the housing managers present a large part of the total number of referrals. This means that housing managers referred residents from their developments to partners. Thus, their importance is not to be underestimated. Yet, the numbers of referrals varies a lot between developments.

Housing managers often have a myriad of tasks at their hands and the residents come to them with many different concerns. Thus, referrals to REES partners do not always seem to be a priority - neither as far as residents' issues are concerned nor for the housing managers in their daily work. Therefore, making referrals should not feel like a big effort for housing managers.

This and the impact of housing managers for referrals implies that the trainings they receive from REES are important so that they are informed and referring comes easy to them. The trainings should continue in the future, also in the case of further public-private partnerships of the development managements.

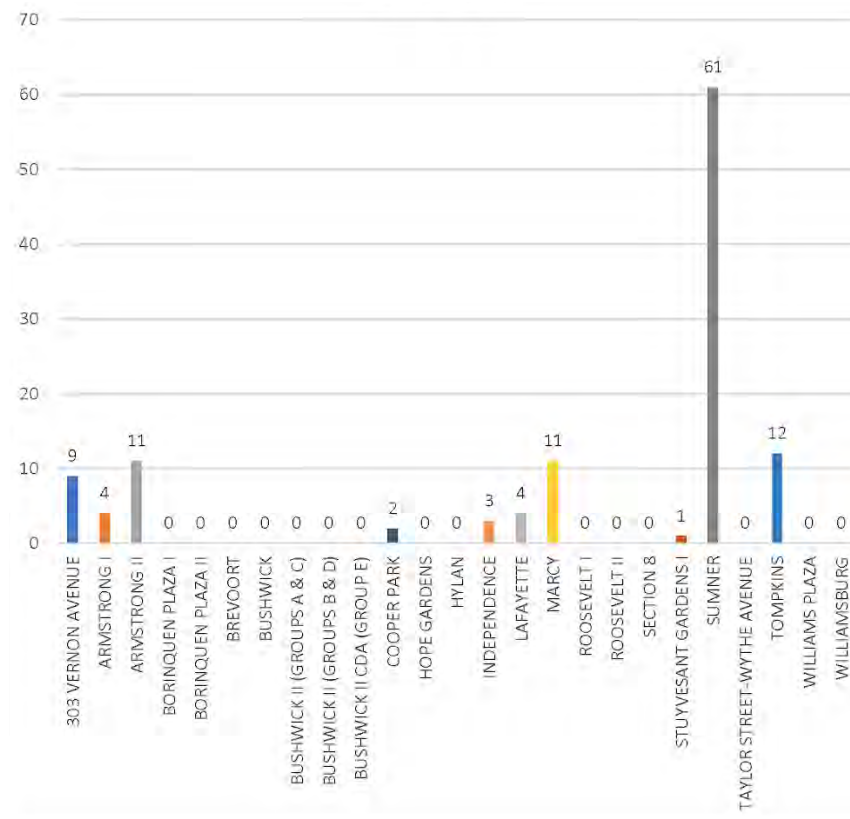
What may inhibit referrals by housing managers is a lack of knowledge about and trust in the partner organizations. This became evident in a meeting we attended between a REES partner, the housing management of a Zone 5 development and the REES Zone 5 coordinator, Evelyn. During the talk, both the partner employees and the housing management built the foundation for a working relationship by finding mutual ties and building trust. Furthermore, they agreed on communication channels and frequency. Thus, efforts to organize those kinds of meetings may be beneficial for building trust between the different actors and develop the notion of a shared vision. They can also lead to institutionalized ties and cooperation. The importance of a good relationship between housing managers and partners also became evident in our interview with a St Nicks employee who stated that the direct contact with the housing management helps her in her outreach as the partner can bring flyers to the management's kiosk, even without the involvement of REES staff.

What should also be considered are official agreements between the developments' housing managements and REES that define and enforce aspired numbers of referrals made by developments to ensure accountability. Thus, the personal ties between the managers and REES, respectively the partners becomes less prevalent and there is an incentive for HA to refer apart from personal preferences.

In future analyses, it would be important to talk to housing managers themselves to ask them for their reasons to refer or not refer residents to partners.

As housing managers play a central role in referring residents, they should be a focus in efforts to increase the number of referrals.

Self-referrals



As mentioned above, the second biggest part of referrals is constituted by **self-referrals**. These are made either with the help of an online portal or by manually filling out a form and putting it in a lockbox that are installed in six of the housing managers' kiosks.

The six developments with lockboxes are: Bushwick I, Armstrong, Lafayette, Marcy, Sumner and Tompkins. As can be seen in the graph, from the data it becomes clear that the highest numbers of self-referrals comes from the developments with lockboxes. Thus, they have a major impact on the numbers of self-referrals as well as on the total number of referrals in zone 5.

As far as obstacles to self-referrals are concerned, there are **two** main recurring issues in the interviews:

First, the partners voiced the impression that residents simply **did not know** that partners' programs and resources exist, that they were eligible to receive them and that they were in close proximity to their homes. The outreach coordinator of St. Nicks Alliance said:

"Sadly there are a lot of people that live in this area, that has about nine NYCHA houses just in this immediate area, that don't even know that we exist, [...] I believe that you should be constant in your outreach and community service, that they need to know that yes, you come from this community, and talk about it all the time."

Second, our interview findings suggest that residents do not seem to be **accustomed to get help** from organizations. The partners mentioned **fear** on the side of residents to get in contact with partners to ask for services. A Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration employee said: "in this community, just asking for help is the most difficult thing to do".

In order to increase the number of referrals, we perceive it as important to **strategically** invest even more in initiatives to make information about REES, the partners and their services known to the residents. The partners' experience shows that it is helpful for them to be visible for the residents, so that they can perceive the partners as an approachable part of the community that is eager to help. This underlines the importance for constant outreach both from the side of REES as well as from partners. So far, mostly **flyers** are used to inform people. The partnership with REES is helpful for partners to deliver these to developments. This in turn is further facilitated by a good relationship between partners and housing managers as they do not only refer residents directly but can also promote partners among residents and point to the services they offer. Aside from flyers, a tool used by Restoration is activity on social media. This way, residents can become aware of their services and this may lower the barrier to contact partners too.

Residents should be better informed about the partnership and the services the partners provide. In order to increase self-referrals, residents should be able to understand the connection between NYCHA, REES and the partners and be able to navigate the self-referral process. Therefore, easily understandable information flyers by REES should be distributed in developments.¹⁵

The graph, which shows the variation in referral numbers, can be used as an indicator where information is lacking to have a more targeted approach to increase the number of self-referrals.

The installation of lockboxes combined with an increase in information on REES and its partners through flyers seems to be an important part of such action. .

¹⁵ An example of such an informative flyer was made by Tiffany Jonassen, a member of our project group as part of another class she took. It can be found at the end of the Report (Part 9).

Further implications for strategic planning of outreach and service provision were revealed in the interviews. First, there are **seasonal changes** in demand for services. In the course of the year, the demand for certain services differs. For example the demand for Restoration's tax counselling peaks from February to April 17th. Our interview partner at St Nicks described different levels of demand, especially for construction as follows:

"Things that are getting close to the school years are starting to die down because people are focusing on getting their kids ready for school. Then it'll build up a little bit but then it'll die down again in November and December because again now people will stop looking for employment [...]. And then it'll peak again after New Year's and it'll stay peaking until summer and it'll slow down again."

Therefore, it is important for partners and for REES to adapt their strategies to reach out and serve residents to the seasonal demand.

Moreover, people's **life stages** are also to be taken into account for outreach and programs. For example Restoration staff know that people **under 25** tend to not see the urgency to receive financial counseling, which is a service that they provide. Knowing which age groups have the highest demand for which services, can help to target certain groups more systematically and successfully.

As far as building **trust** is concerned, our interviewees perceived being seen in person by residents as helpful. This would be facilitated by partner employees' visits at developments through, for example, information sessions or just for the distribution of flyers. In the interview with Restoration staff, another strategy was mentioned that combines the aims of creating awareness and being seen in person: they organize events that do not necessarily have to do with their services and invite the broader public. By placing flyers in the event room, people get to notice the services and can pose questions they may have on the spot. Yet, it is important to keep in mind that events depend on funding, which not necessarily all partners have. Thus, it is not necessarily a measure that can be implemented by all the REES partners.

All in all, the three main types of referrals complement each other to some extent. For example, developments that show a high number of self-referrals, may have less referrals by REES or by housing managers. Thus, for future implementation, this should be kept in mind when seeking targeted action to increase the number of referrals for each development. It should be the aim to have a similarly high number of referrals - irrespective of the type - for each development.

5.2. Appointments

According to the data, from the 365 referrals made in 2016 in Zone 5, 127 (34.8%) resulted in appointments. Consequently, more than 60% of residents who were referred, **did not make an appointment** with a partnering organization. As this tendency is found for all the partners, to some extent, this drop seems to be a normal part of the referral timeline. Yet, if the loss of residents in the process is too high, this is problematic for the partnership as its aim is to connect residents to services and thus depends on the successful arrangement of appointments after initial referrals. It would be important for future analyses to declare an aspired threshold for the numbers of appointments in relation to referrals to better assess what is to be considered normal or problematic.

PARTNERS			
	REFERRALS	APPT. MADE	APPT. ATTENDED
BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION	90	49	48
BROOKLYN EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITY CENTER	10	4	0
HENRY STREET SETTLEMENT- ADULT EDUCATION	2	1	1
JOBS PLUS (BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION)	34	16	4
MANHATTAN EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITY CENTER (MEOC)	1	1	1
NYC BUSINESS SOLUTIONS CENTER- BROOKLYN	8	1	0
NYCHA RESIDENT TRAINING ACADEMY (NRTA)	10	4	2
OFE - FINANCIAL EMPOWERMENT CENTER	67	9	No Data
OPPORTUNITIES FOR A BETTER TOMORROW	44	4	0
PRATT AREA COMMUNITY COUNCIL	1	0	0
RBSCC HOMEBASE	12	4	2
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- ADULT EDUCATION	13	5	0
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- EMPLOYMENT ASSISTANCE	60	26	4
THE HOPE PROGRAM	13	3	No Data
TOTAL	365	127	62

Out of the 222 that **did not make an appointment**, a third (33.3%, 74 people) indicated that they were **not interested**, which is the biggest group for the residents who did not make an appointment. The second biggest number (appr. 18%, 39 people) consists of residents who are **unresponsive**.

	NO APPT.
ALREADY RECEIVING THIS SERVICE FROM ORGANIZATION	11
DID NOT QUALIFY FOR FOOD STAMPS	2
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 1 TIME	40
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 2 TIMES	17
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 3 TIMES	8
NO VOICE MAIL/BUSY SIGNAL	6
NOT INTERESTED	74
NUMBER NOT RECEIVING CALLS - WILL TRY AGAIN	18
PHONE NUMBER NOT WORKING	7
UNRESPONSIVE/NO FURTHER ATTEMPTS	39
TOTAL	222

The partners as well as the residents are the main actors in the process of appointment making. The interviews we conducted with partners gave us insights into hindrances to appointments on their side. Moreover, they also shed light on obstacles and challenges in interactions with residents, which entail the partners' impressions of residents' reactions on the phone. These can only be considered as interpretations and it would be important for future analyses to include residents' voices themselves in order to get a complete picture of those crucial first interactions between residents and partners. It would also be important in order to learn why residents indicate that they are not interested.

We still consider the partners' experiences and subjective impressions as important because they shape the way they work with residents, find ways to handle situations and develop strategies to get residents to make an appointment.

Residents

Above, we mentioned that fear may be a reason for residents to not make a referral or be referred. This issue is also relevant when it comes to appointments.

With regards to his impression that a lot of referred residents are **skeptical** of organizations, our interview partner from Restoration said:

*"so we have to - as an organization- prove them, okay not only we're here to help you, but we're different.
[...] Let me help you! But it takes us time."*

This reveals that frontline staff who first speak to the residents must be patient and understanding of residents' former unpleasant experiences with other programs, and their attitudes resulting from this. The interview partners from Restoration characterized it as **"customer service"** mentality.

As **frontline** staff, they are the **clients' first encounter** with the organization and can shape the residents' view of the organization and their attitude towards their services. Thus, the way frontline staff speak to and treat the clients can **make a very big difference**. Moreover, what is important for the appointments is **persistence**. Residents who are hesitant at first may be convinced to try the services if they see that an organization and its staff care about them.

Every organization and its employees may develop different ways and techniques to do that. For REES, it would be important to communicate these possible challenges to partners so that they can expect that from the very start and prepare their frontline staff.

Partners

One difficulty we encountered for partners in accommodating the demands of residents and organizing appointments, is understaffing.

At the partner organization Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow (OBT), for instance, for a period of time only one person worked with the REES referral system. This led to a large number of referrals to OBT not being followed up and thus being left open without the residents being served. Due to a meeting with Evelyn, OBT has changed this by now.

Connected to the issue of **understaffing** as a challenge for making appointments with residents are the number of different obligations in the partnering organizations. Our interviewees from Restoration characterized the fact that they have many other contracts to serve other than REES can be overwhelming in terms of capacity.

A good practice for increasing the number of appointments is a **productivity report**. The frontline staff of Bed-Stuy Restoration, which has the highest number in appointments made, have to complete a Productivity Report. This system prescribes them certain tasks they have to fulfill. Thus, it enforces their duties to prioritize and complete all the tasks in order and in a timely manner.

Apart from that, our interview partner at St Nicks Alliance lamented that the digital referral system was not differentiated enough for their organization. As only two categories are applied in the referral process, this did not adequately reflect the services they provide: "[...] it's just two categories. And it's hard to elaborate what a resident really wants into two categories. I would love to see their referral system updated to employment service, adult education and *vocational training programs*." (St Nicks Alliance interview). Thus, it takes them more time to find out what services the residents need. It may also have the effect that by judging from the categories, partners' employees do not consider a resident to need the service they provide.

This presents a tension between the needs of housing managers for the referral system to be as easy and uncomplicated as possible and the partners to have more detailed information to know what they can offer the residents. A first step for REES could be to talk to the partners about their concerns and to inform HA as well as partners in trainings about the reasons for the limitation to two categories.

5.3. Appointment attendance

The next step in the referral system is the **residents' attendance** of scheduled appointments. These appointments can entail counselling or an information session, a test or a training. Their attendance depends on the services the partners provide but mostly on what the residents need and their commitment to attend. In 2016, 62 people attended an appointment to receive the service from one of Zone 5's partners. This means that almost half (48.8%) of the people who made appointments also attended them. Conclusively, taking all numbers of referrals made, 16.9% of the people who were initially referred, ultimately attended an appointment.

Residents

The step of appointment attendance should be mostly explained by residents themselves as it is them who do or do not show up to an appointment. As we could not interview residents, we take the partners' elaborations as a proxy to understanding possible barriers for residents to attend an appointment.

The major issue for residents that comes up in the interviews with the partners, is **trust**.

As our St Nicks interview partner said:

"Sometimes they come in, sometimes they don't. They sound really enthused in the very beginning, and I guess it's just fear of 'is it worth it, is it true?'. It's a 'too good to be true' kind of thing. So they get a little leery about it. But if they keep seeing me, they know that I'm real, they know that what I offer is real."

This requires a lot of personal commitment from the partner organizations' frontline staff. As mentioned before, both St Nicks Alliance and Bed-Stuy Restoration interviews show that being seen by the residents enhances trust in the partners and their services. It should also be taken into consideration that the staff we interviewed perceived trust to be building over time. This in turn demands constant and long-term involvement in the community on the part of the organizations.

Apart from that, the formats of partners' services in terms of **schedules** and duration could be a hindrance for residents to take part. Our St Nicks interview partner said: *"Like at first it sounds really good 'yeah I want that', but when they read they see that it's a six-week training, it's from 8:30 to 4:40, five days out of the week, that's a lot"*.

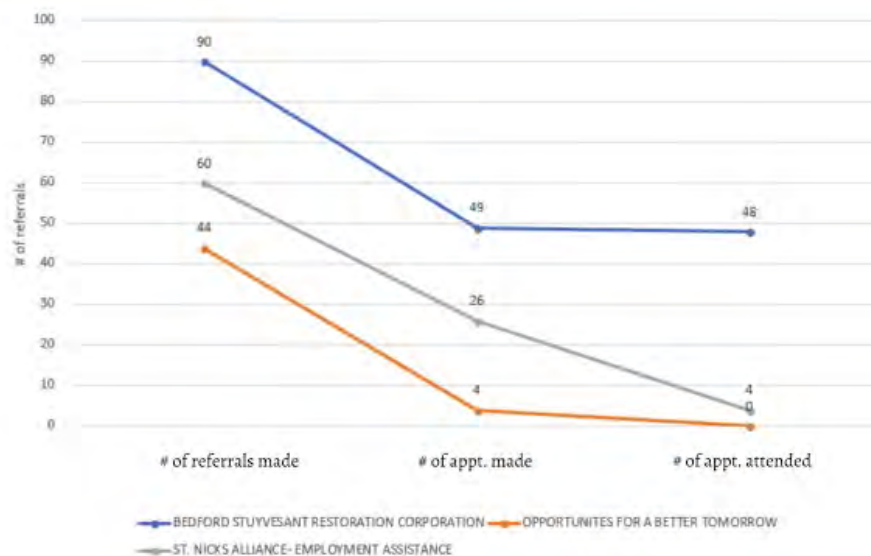
For REES, it could be worth to consider partnering with organizations that offer more flexible or more diverse training sessions that can accommodate residents' timely needs.

Partners

To result in a high rate of attended appointments, it appears that an official and **enforced system** for the frontline communications staff that organizes how to get people to attend their appointments, make a drastic difference. Bed-Stuy Restoration, which has the highest rate of appointments attended

in relation to appointments made, systematically make a reminder call the day before a scheduled appointment to confirm that the service seeker will be coming. In behavioral science, the **Nudge Theory**¹⁶ proposes that positive reinforcement and indirect suggestions (confirming/reminding if a person is coming the next day or indirectly suggesting to do so) is a technique to influence the behavior and decision making of people. This adjustment for staff who are communicating with residents could have a big impact on the number of attended appointments.

BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION	90	49	48
OPPORTUNITIES FOR A BETTER TOMORROW	44	4	0
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- EMPLOYMENT ASSISTANCE	60	26	4



LINEAR CHAIN TIMELINE

Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation



¹⁶ MDRC. "Nudging Change In Human Services", https://www.mdrc.org/sites/default/files/2017_MDRC_BIAS_Final_Report_FR.pdf

CONCLUSIONS

PART 6

With rising housing prices in New York City, NYCHA is an important institution that helps its residents to live affordably and access services that help them in various ways. Being one of NYCHA's departments, REES has the aim to help residents strive and reach their full potential by empowering them economically. On a practical level, their noble goals involve a myriad of different actors and institutions, each with their own goals, strategies and issues.

By focusing on REES's referral partnership, we analyzed and assessed a part of REES we consider to be especially important for the achievement of their goal. A successful referral, which includes the referral to a partner, the scheduling of an appointment and its attendance, presents an opportunity for NYCHA residents to use local services that will help them economically on a long term basis.

In general, REES as well as the three partnering organizations we interviewed are satisfied with the partnership. They feel that their "missions align" as they share the same vision of helping the community (Bed-Stuy Restoration interview). The partners benefit from the partnership with REES because it allows them to have a larger platform and to thus reach a greater number of people whom they can help. Moreover, the label NYCHA gives the partners more credibility among NYCHA residents. We detected hindrances and opportunities for each of the step by using quantitative and qualitative data. The analysis shows that targeted action is important to use different channels of referring. Moreover, the partners' commitment and a "service culture" is helpful in increasing the numbers of appointments and their attendance.

Our analysis shows that in the three stages of the referral process, a lack of trust on the part of the residents is a major issue. For REES and its partners, it is important to keep in mind that this trust develops and increases over time. Trust can be built by being patient with residents, understanding where their suspicions stem from and signalling them that they care. Being visible and establishing a personal connection to the community is also important. Thus, partners' long-term commitment is vital for a bigger impact in the future.

We see a lot of potential for the improvement of referral numbers. In our opinion, an important aspect of this is the strengthening of the relationship between the stakeholders and regular communication between them. Analogous to REES's goal of sustainability for residents, the partnerships as well as the links between developments and local organizations should also be long-term and sustainable.

AREAS OF OPPORTUNITIES

PART 7

Referrals

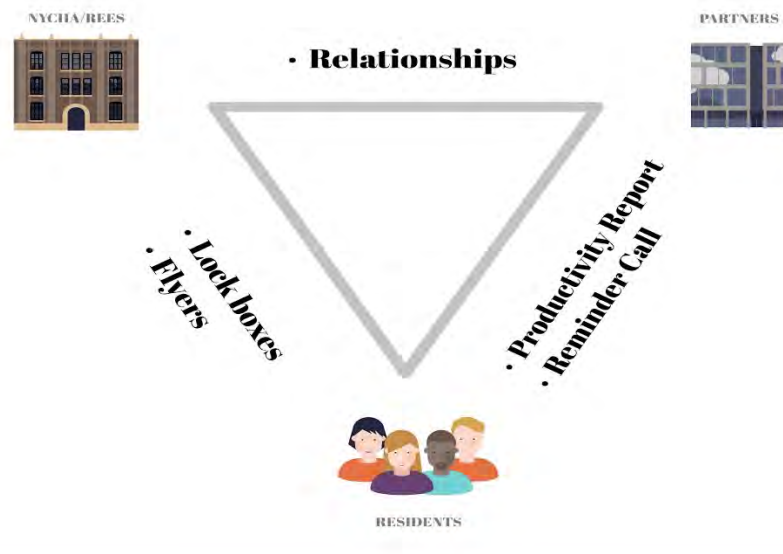
- Find an agreement with housing managers for referral rates.
- Systematically analyze why housing assistance refer or not refer.
- Continue trainings for housing assistants.
- Strengthen the relationship and communication between housing assistants and partners.
- Outreach:
 - Targeted outreach for specific demographics and seasonal demands.
 - Easily understandable information on REES and partners and how to refer or be referred.
 - Find strategic locations for promotion of services (banks, public events, tables in streets).
- Install lockboxes in developments.

Appointments

- Assess the aspired rate of appointments made.
- Productivity Report for partners' frontline staff.
- Communicate challenges to partners so that they are prepared.

Appointment attendance

- Reminder a day before appointment.
- Systematic analysis of reasons why residents do not attend appointments.



LIMITATIONS & REFLECTIONS

PART 8

Being a school project conducted by undergraduate and Master's students within one semester (four months), there are certain limitations to our assessment.

Comparing the data we received from REES with assertions made during field visits and interviews, we were not sure to what extent the data is complete. Due to the data migration facilitated in 2017, and a recurring pattern of blanks left across our spreadsheet, we had to work under the assumption that the quantitative data may not absolutely reflect accurate realities. Nonetheless, we chose to work with the data from 2016 as we believed that 2016 would give us the optimal level of accuracy due to its closest relevance to 2018 before the migration.

Moreover, there is neither information on residents' completion of services nor does REES further keep track of the residents that have used partners' services. At least one partner we interviewed follows the employment status of the people who take their services. Although there are confidentiality issues, it could be worth to consider sharing this information with REES so that REES's goal of helping NYCHA residents *sustainably* can be better assessed.

Furthermore, we would like to address the limitations concerning our qualitative analysis. As we already stated above, the assertions made on behalf of the residents by our interview partners are subjective generalized patterns from their perspective, which we find helpful to understand the partners' experience and their interpretations, which influence their work with residents. But these assertions are not the direct reasonings coming from the residents themselves. We would have liked to interview residents to understand what obstacles they face directly. However, conducting this research as an extension of NYCHA, we decided that we were not in a position to interview because of ethical reasons and constraints in time and resources. In order to be methodologically concise, we would have had to interview residents who had been referred as well as residents who had never been referred and who may even never have heard of REES. This was impossible to do because this would have meant the violation of residents' privacy.

We would highly recommend to include interviews with residents in a way that includes their consent in future evaluations of the partnership.

The qualitative findings are not generalizable due to the small number of interviews and the few field visits over a relatively short period of time. Yet, we argue that the findings are helpful as they reflect experiences and subjective impressions of people who work with REES.

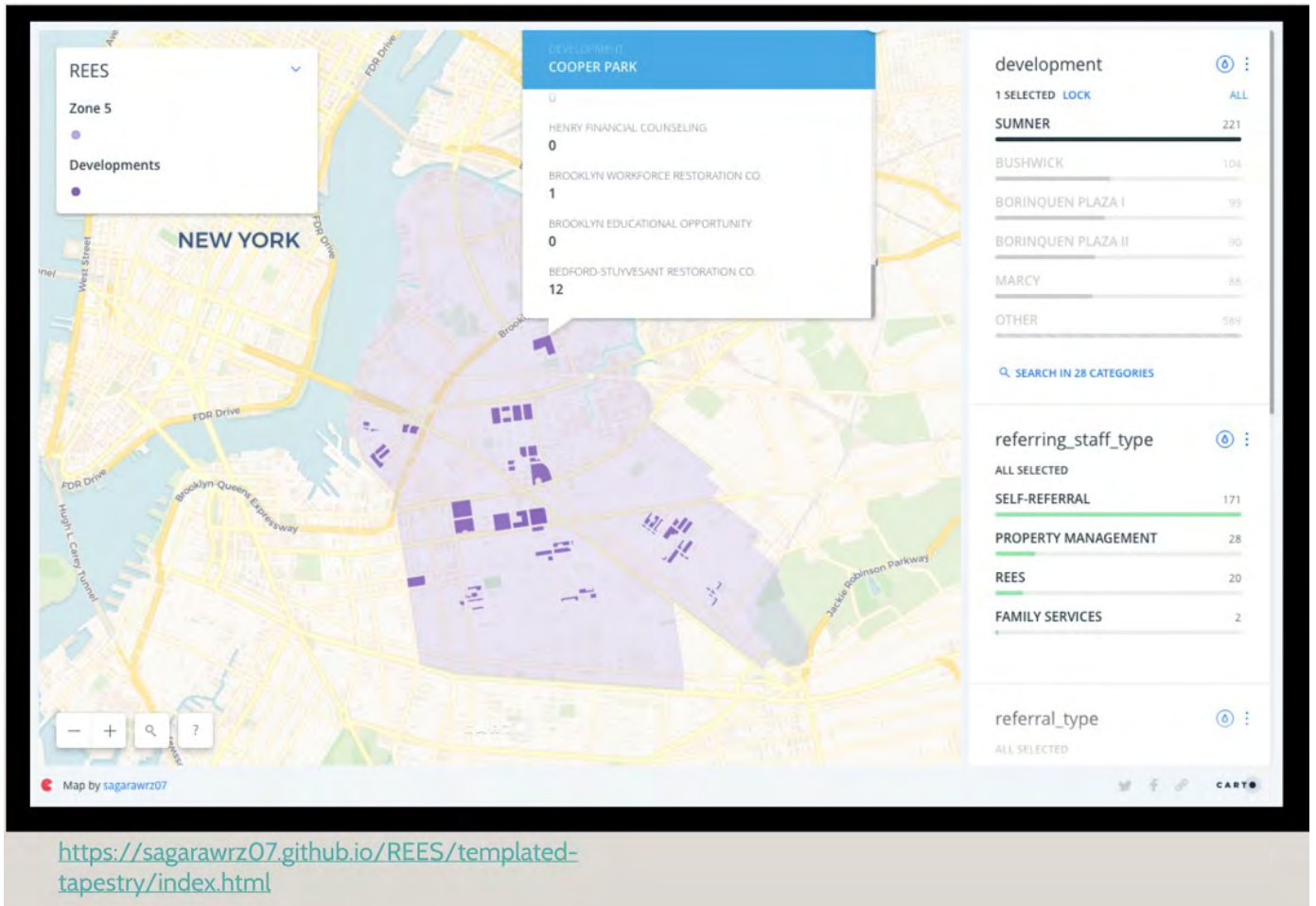
Despite the fact that we raised our concerns with the level of inconsistencies we have seen throughout some of the quantitative data - from the extractions of the numbers we worked with from 2016, we believe that charting the numbers of referrals made, appointments made, and appointments attended in a linear chain like our timeline, can help determine the relative performance of a partner. It is not a comprehensive picture of their performances, however it gives a general structure to compare their performances relative to other partners. We credit this timeline to have some level of accountability, because of the direct reflection of the way each partner conducts their tasks. After each interview, and performing a comparative analysis on the transcripts of the interviews, we have noticed patterns, which support the numbers that we charted in the graph. For example, the best numbers by Restoration made sense when we acquired the qualitative knowledge that they perform particular practices that helped them have better client turnout rates. Thus, we suggest, that even a simple examination can serve as one components of partner evaluations.

SIDE PROJECTS

Map (Claudio) 2. **Flyer** (Tiffany)

PART 9

MAP



2. FLYER

WHAT IS REES ?

NYCHA's Office of Resident Economic Empowerment & Sustainability (REES) supports residents to increase their **income** and **assets** through programs, policies, and collaborations in **FOUR** key areas:

- 1) Employment and Career Advancement
- 2) Adult Education and Vocational training
- 3) Financial Empowerment
- 4) Resident Business Development

REES offers a wide array of **services** through **partnerships** and collaborations with **local** organizations.

REES is committed to **CONNECTING** residents to high quality programs in neighborhoods throughout New York City.

REES refers to this approach as the **"Zone Model."**

OUR STRUCTURE



Open booklet for more details about the services our partners provide

OPPORTUNITY CONNECT is a NYCHA Self-Service Portal. The new self-service feature is free and easy to use. Authorized NYCHA residents and NYCHA Section 8 voucher holders ages 18 and up can log into Opportunity Connect to make a self-referral.

If you do not have access to a computer or smartphone, you can receive a referral by speaking with a **REES Zone Partner**; or by visiting a **Management Office** to speak with your **Housing Assistant** and asking for a referral; or by calling the **REES Hotline** at (718) 289-8100 and making an appointment for a **REES Information Session**.

VISIT: <https://selfserve.nycha.info>

REFERRAL SYSTEM EXPLAINED

You must refer yourself, or be referred to the appropriate partner so that they can contact you and make an appointment to provide you with the needed services.

CONTACT US

787 Atlantic Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11238

REES Hotline: 718-289-8100

<http://opportunitynycha.org/>

YOU'RE IN ZONE 5



RESIDENTS ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT & SUSTAINABILITY



Jobs Plus provides integrated services to public housing residents to help them achieve their financial and employment goals and advance in the labor market. Offerings include comprehensive job training and placement services, child support counseling, work supports, social service referrals, and financial counseling.

630 Flushing Ave 1st Floor
Brooklyn NY 11206

Phone: 917-267-5575

FINANCIAL EMPOWERMENT

WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT



Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow helps disadvantaged youth and adults to recognize their own self-worth, and advance towards self-sufficiency and financial security through job training, academic reinforcement, improved life skills, job placement, and support services.

PROGRAMS: Youth Ed & Job Training; Young Adult Internship; Medical Admin. Assistant Training Program; Web Design & Coding Program; Young Adult Literacy Program; Adult Services; Immigrant Services

Locations in Bushwick & Bedford Stuyvesant
<https://obtjobs.org/all-programs/>

VOCATIONAL TRAINING

WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT



The mission of Bridge Street Development Corporation, is to build partnerships with businesses, government, and other community stakeholders to provide civic and economic opportunities to the residents of Central Brooklyn with a focus on low income households.

PROGRAMS: Housing Development; Homeownership Services; Community Engagement; Economic Development; Senior Services

460 Nostrand Avenue,
Brooklyn, New York 11216

Phone: 718-399-0146

FOOD STAMPS SCREENING



We help businesses start, operate, and grow by:

- Helping minority and women-owned businesses (M/WBES) get City-certified and compete for contracts
- Connecting entrepreneurs to free resources ranging from business courses to legal services
- Explaining government rules and regulations
- Helping entrepreneurs apply for funding to launch or grow a business

CENTER & SERVICE LOCATIONS:

Find a NYC Department of Small Business Services, NYC Business Solutions Center, Workforce Career Center, or Employment Works Center @ <http://www1.nyc.gov/site/sbs/businesses/businesses.page>

RESIDENT BUSINESS DEV.



To facilitate economic self-sufficiency and family stability among low and moderate-income residents of Central Brooklyn, provide opportunities for upward mobility, help people build assets and savings, improve educational attainment among youth, promote healthy living, and harness the power of arts and culture to build a healthy sense of community.

<http://restorationplaza.org/>

1368 Fulton St
Brooklyn, NY 11216
Phone: (718) 636-6900

FOOD STAMPS SCREENING



St. Nick's Alliance seeks to transform lives of low- and moderate-income people through employment, education, housing, and health care. We do this by delivering impactful services with measurable outcomes to children, adults, and the elderly. As a civic anchor we carry out this mission within the context of building a sustainable community for all people through the arts, environmental advocacy, and urban planning.

<https://www.stnicksalliance.org/>
2 Kingsland Avenue, Brooklyn, NY
Phone: 718-388-5454

ADULT EDUCATION

VOCATIONAL TRAINING

WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT



The State University of New York Brooklyn Educational Opportunity Center (BEOC) is part of a network of 10 EOC's and 2 Outreach Centers throughout New York State. Founded in 1966, BEOC provides tuition free academic and career training to over 1600 eligible New York residents annually. Free tutoring, internship and job placement services are provided to students and alumni.

111 Livingston Street
Brooklyn, NY 11201
Phone: 718-802-3330
Email: admissions@beoc.suny.edu

ADULT EDUCATION



Since 1973, we've offered services designed to support every generation and meet the needs of communities. Our divisions encompass seniors, housing, education, health and empowerment.

<https://www.riseboro.org/rb/>
555 Bushwick Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11206

FOOD STAMPS SCREENING



Brooklyn Cooperative Federal Credit Union is a community credit union serving Central Brooklyn. Brooklyn Coop's mission is to further wealth-building, opportunity, and resilience in our communities by offering fair and affordable financial services. Branch locations: Bushwick & Bedford Stuyvesant
P: 718.418.8232 x0

FOOD STAMPS SCREENING

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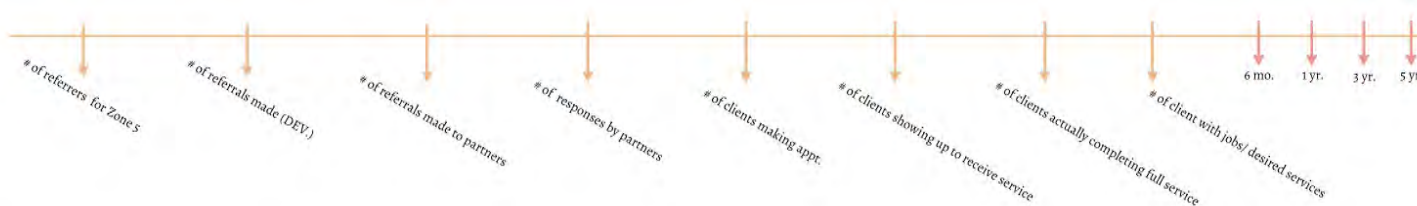
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APPENDIX

1. Timeline

INPUT

OUTPUT



Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation

INPUT

OUTPUT

365

90

49

48

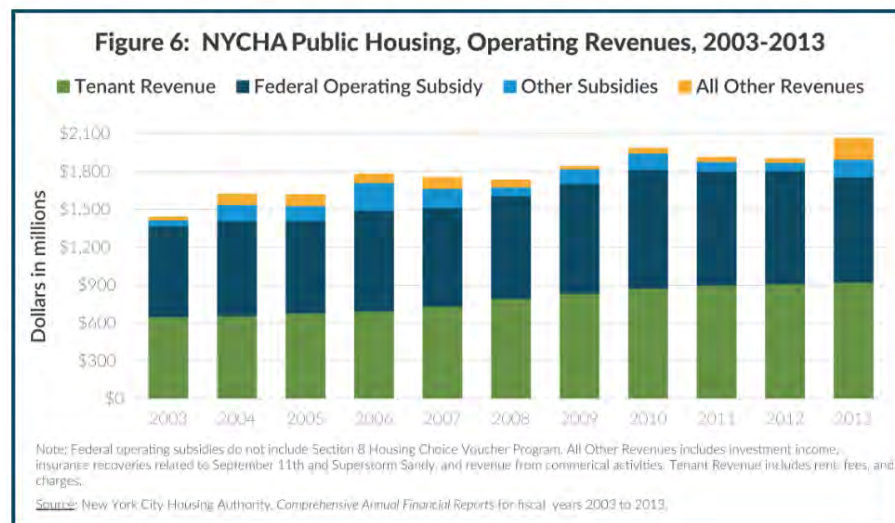
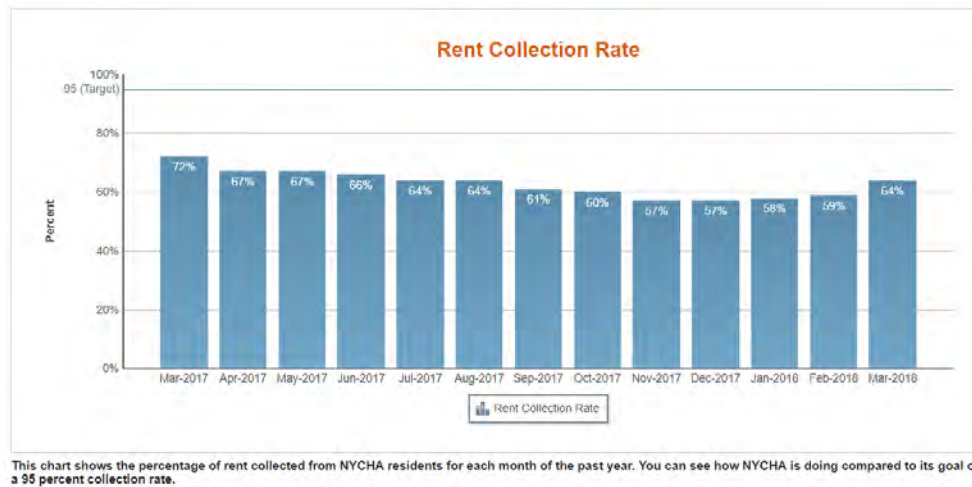
of referrers for Zone 5

of referrals made to RESTORATION

of clients making appt.

of clients showing up to receive service

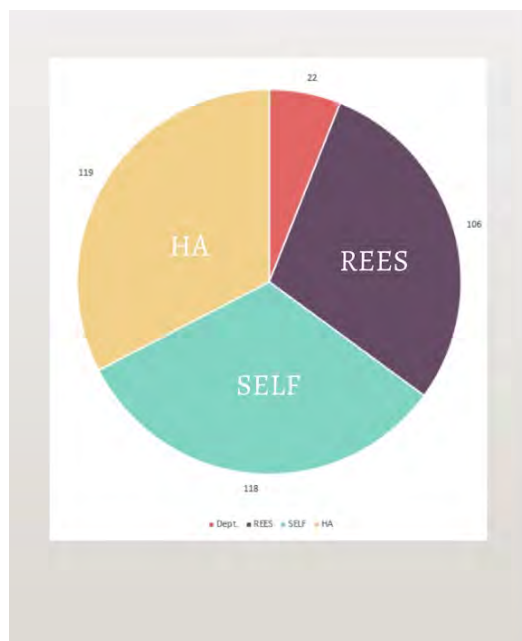
2. Graphs



				# of referrals made to partners		# of clients making appointment	# of clients attending app.							
Dept.	22	Dev. 1	11	Ptr. 1	90	data	49	48	data	data	data	data	data	data
REES	106	Dev. 2	10	Ptr. 2	10	data	4	0	data	data	data	data	data	data
Self	118	Dev. 3	20	Ptr. 3	2	data	1	1	data	data	data	data	data	data
HA	119	Dev. 4	54	Ptr. 4	34	data	16	4	data	data	data	data	data	data
TOTAL	=	Dev. 5	24	Ptr. 5	1	data	1	1	data	data	data	data	data	data
	365	Dev. 6	7	Ptr. 6	8	data	1	0	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev. 7	23	Ptr. 7	10	data	4	2	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev. 8	1	Ptr. 8	67	data	9	NO data	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev. 9	2	Ptr. 9	44	data	4	0	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.10	1	Ptr.10	1	data	0	0	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.11	7	Ptr.11	12	data	4	2	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.12	1	Ptr.12	13	data	5	0	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.13	5	Ptr.13	60	data	26	4	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.14	3	Ptr.14	13	data	3	NO data	data	data	data	data	data	data
		Dev.15	8											
		Dev.16	20											
		Dev.17	7											
		Dev.18	2											
		Dev.19	21											
		Dev.20	4											
		Dev.21	69											
		Dev.22	3											
		Dev.23	28											
		Dev.24	25											
		Dev.25	9											

2016 - Zone 5

TOTAL: 365 PEOPLE



Dept.

22

REES

106

Self

118

HA

119

TOTAL

=

365

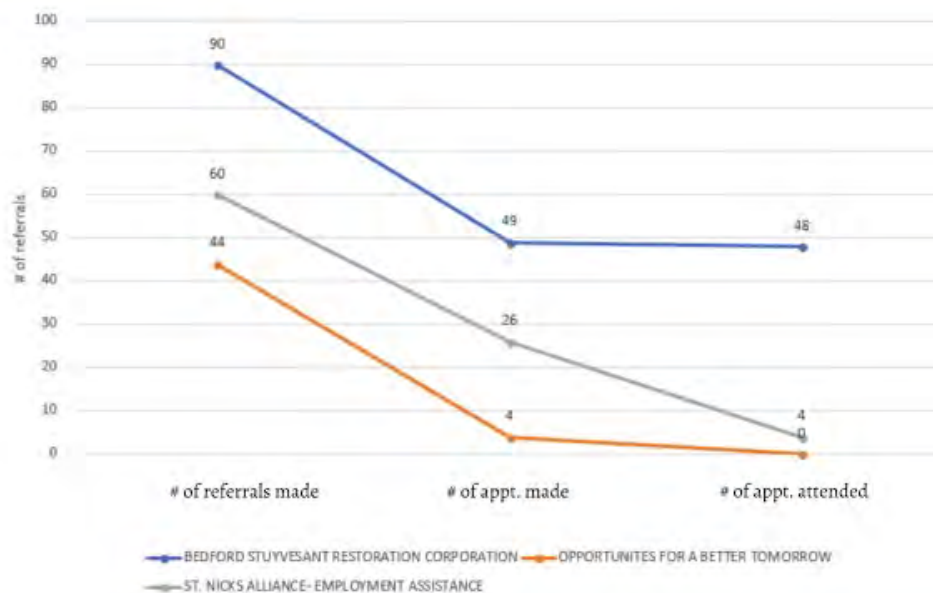
PARTNERS

	REFERRALS	APPT. MADE	APPT. ATTENDED
BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION	90	49	48
BROOKLYN EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITY CENTER	10	4	0
HENRY STREET SETTLEMENT- ADULT EDUCATION	2	1	1
JOBS PLUS (BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION)	34	16	4
MANHATTAN EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITY CENTER (MEOC)	1	1	1
NYC BUSINESS SOLUTIONS CENTER- BROOKLYN	8	1	0
NYCHA RESIDENT TRAINING ACADEMY (NRTA)	10	4	2
OFE - FINANCIAL EMPOWERMENT CENTER	67	9	No Data
OPPORTUNITIES FOR A BETTER TOMORROW	44	4	0
PRATT AREA COMMUNITY COUNCIL	1	0	0
RBSCC HOMEBASE	12	4	2
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- ADULT EDUCATION	13	5	0
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- EMPLOYMENT ASSISTANCE	60	26	4
THE HOPE PROGRAM	13	3	No Data
TOTAL	365	127	62

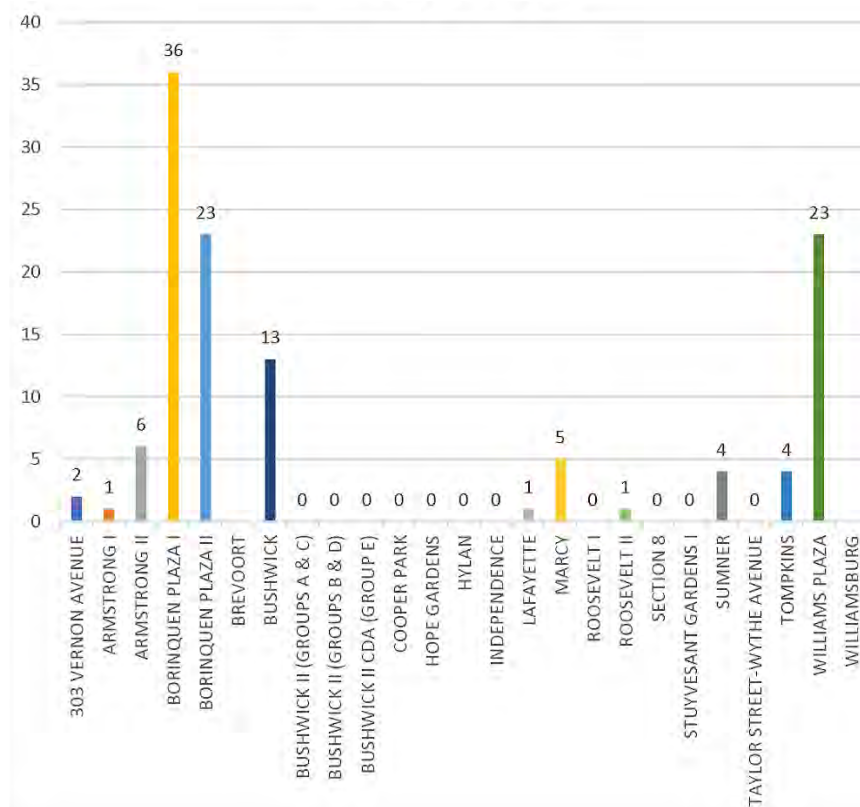
	NO APPT.
ALREADY RECEIVING THIS SERVICE FROM ORGANIZATION	11
DID NOT QUALIFY FOR FOOD STAMPS	2
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 1 TIME	40
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 2 TIMES	17
LEFT VOICE MESSAGE 3 TIMES	8
NO VOICE MAIL/BUSY SIGNAL	6
NOT INTERESTED	74
NUMBER NOT RECEIVING CALLS - WILL TRY AGAIN	18
PHONE NUMBER NOT WORKING	7
UNRESPONSIVE/NO FURTHER ATTEMPTS	39
TOTAL	222

EDUCATION	
" "	78
ASSOCIATE DEGREE	10
BACHELORS DEGREE	5
COMPLETED HIGH SCHOOL	140
GED	17
NO HIGH SCHOOL DIPLOMA OR	115
TOTAL	365

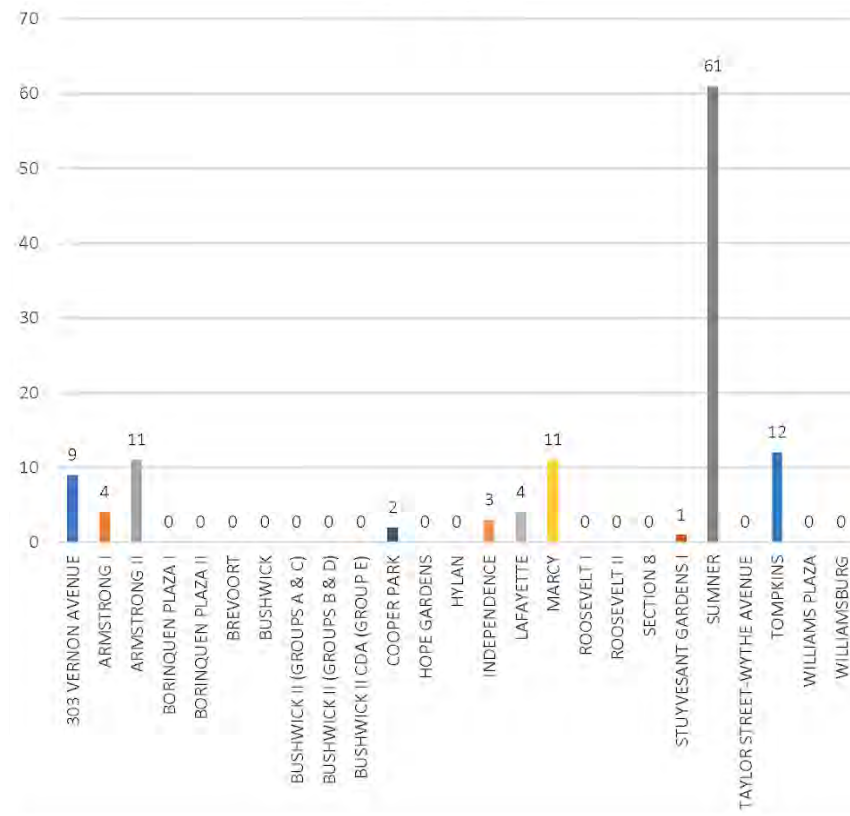
BEDFORD STUYVESANT RESTORATION CORPORATION	90	49	48
OPPORTUNITES FOR A BETTER TOMORROW	44	4	0
ST. NICKS ALLIANCE- EMPLOYMENT ASSISTANCE	60	26	4



NUMBER OF REFERRALS BY HOUSING MANAGERS



NUMBER OF REFERRALS BY SELF-REFERRALS



3. Field Notes

Meeting with Housing Assistants of a development and Jobs Plus employees

February 7, 2018, duration: 1.5 hours

Claudio, Nuriani

- Jobs Plus is assigned to 3 developments
- Jobs Plus and developments have been working together for 6 years
- 450 individuals in development
- Assistants say that outreach is needed + communication about events
- Younger people need more support
 - Jobs Plus offers work progress program: 12 week internship for 18-24 year olds
 - For residents older than 25: Jobs Plus Model: resource managers, career coaches who help define and accomplish employment and education goals.
 - Jobs Plus has cooperation with citibikes
 - They have a monthly hot jobs list. They agree that they will send it to the housing assistants in the future (has not been done before)
- What Evelyn and Jobs Plus employees emphasize is that it's important that the assistants refer residents to Jobs Plus and use the form to track them and include REES. Residents are supposed to fill out the form, the managers should scan them and send them to REES, where Evelyn takes care of the rest
- New residents should fill out form directly
- Cross Training demonstrate that the partners are invested and demonstrate their willingness to get to know more about NYCHA.
- Different measures to track improvement from managers, partnership and REES needed. This will help to set goals and to allocate resources properly. (ask REES - and other stakeholders - "what is success for you?")
- Partnerships doing outreach on-site at lobbies and other areas of NYCHA facilities. Allows them to get in contact with the residents.
- Partners need to demonstrate success in order to increase their funds and expand.
- A manager expressed not trusting REES/NYCHA so much? Trust being an issue
- Some residents of NYCHA are trying to stay low or feel in vulnerable positions where they have to hide. Reaching them requires trust.
- Need to monitor
- Other Issues:
 - Recertification. Suggestion: residents can use Jobs Plus' computers. Objection: Residents don't like working with people they don't know
 - Risk of eviction is not reported
 - Challenges housing assistants mention: residents not paying rent, elderly abuse, people take over other people's apartment illegally
 - child support and the difficulties of single parents to find a job and supervision for child
 - undocumented immigrants
 - mental health
 - Unmonitored progress or follow up from those who are referred
 - Design of the forms, people might not feel they need help or don't want to feel they need assistance. Less specific forms that only ask for consent, not for people to specify their problems, as problems might be interconnected anyway.
- Decisions:
 - Jobs Plus will give a quarterly feedback to the development about how many people got a job after a referral [maybe a lack of accountability/proof of success also keeps managers/assistants from referring residents to partners]
 - Meetings between managers and Jobs Plus
 - Emails with information once a month

Family Partnership referral training monitor w/Evelyn

February 12, 2018, duration: 2 hours each

Meeting 1: Claudio, Meeting 2: Tiffany, Nuriani

Meeting 1:

- Computer literacy a problem - some couldn't even log in -
- Managers unaware of basic procedures
- What's the motivation for managers to do more referrals?
- They are expected to do "complex" procedures to upload the referral and consent forms. Management of referrals gets difficult while being on the field.
- Constant update of formats, and UI on NYCHA website
- How many residents go outside their area or burrough to look for services that are not in their immediacy?
- How to evaluate, track and motivate the performance of the managers?
- Which services are NYCHA only?

Meeting 2:

- Some of the Family Partnership employees are also NYCHA residents
- Training about filling out form online for referring residents to partners
- Partners have to contact residents within 24-48 hours
- Housing assistants also get the training [--> How often?]
- Some/ many residents don't have computers or cellphones (accessibility to communication)
- One trainee asked why she doesn't see flyers in the buildings
- Is the referral system the only option in the conditions that exists? No alternatives?
 - Are they planning to develop an app for the referrals? Instead of carrying paper forms and manually transferring them when they get to the office?
 - Can they use ads/ mailing with the amount of resources spent on training referrers?

Meeting between Opportunities for Better Tomorrow (OBT) and Evelyn

February 13, 2018, duration: 1.5 hours

Eric

- Four OBT members in attendance, mix of management/staff levels
- This was a meeting to give OBT another chance to continue receiving referrals as a REES partner. OBT has been a partner for 5+ years but started falling behind on connecting referrals.
 - OBT was originally overwhelmed with the amount of referrals they received, unable to contact and connect every referred resident.
 - This meeting was a training for more OBT staff to use the REES service portal
- All referrals to OBT are for Adult Education services
- When a referral to OBT's services are made, OBT has 24-48hrs to reach out to the client or REES is automatically notified.
- Evelyn then checks response times
- There's a 15 referral maximum to OBT from REES per day

Green City Force Information Session

February 28, 2018, duration: 1 hour

Eric and Claudio

<http://www.greencityforce.org/>

Green City Force is an AmeriCorps program that partners with REES to recruit 18-24yr old NYCHA residents for professional training in environmental initiatives.

- Green City Corps members go thru a 6 or 10 month program full-time program.
- Some members focus on urban agriculture projects around the developments
- Others do other services like energy audits and environmental education. Smoke-free housing initiative
- Members receive a small living stipend and metro card. An education award and prospective careers are available upon completion.
 - GCF work does not affect NYCHA rent, so it doesn't increase
- Members don't need to be on the lease, but still need to prove NYCHA residents
- GCF also receives money from Mayor's Action Plan for Neighborhood Safety (MAP)
 - This focuses their recruitment efforts on ~16 developments that the mayor's office found to cause ~20% of crime in NYCHA
 - Only ~15% of recruits can be from non-MAP developments.
 - Wesley the GCF member giving presentation was sad about this. Because although they received money, it limits their impact on the rest of NYCHA
- 10 residents attended info session, average is about 8
- Old recruitment process: Info session on Thu, tryouts held following Tues
- New: Info on Wed, Tryouts on Thu.
 - Wesley said that the old gap was too much time for the younger demographic they were trying to recruit.
 - Found that the recruits were more responsive to the faster turnaround

Meeting with REES intern and Evelyn

March 6, 2018, duration: 1.5 hours

Eric and Nuriani

- We presented briefly what our project will be about
- Ahmadou (the intern) said that it's a good approach
- His suggestions are:
 - to get to know the zone better, as well as the partners and the residents' needs
 - look at term sheet (MOU) which NYCHA and partners sign and which is an agreement about the commitment and goals the partners promise to fulfill
 - Look at the distance between residents and partners [although I think that it's not a big issue in our zone]
 - Jobs Plus gets the least amount of referrals from Lafayette residents due to their distance, no other examples given
 - Ask partners how they know if residents have been served
- Data comes from cebil - data board
- Some NYCHA developments are beginning to privatize
- Evelyn explained that new partners sign an MOU agreement for generally one year as a trial, if the partnership is successful they'll be asked to renew for a 3+ year agreement
 - She mentioned how OBT was put back on a trial period and she would check back with their efforts in a month.
- Evelyn mentioned that she has 7 lockboxes across different developments to help increase the number of referrals she receives. It helps properly reflect the amount of referrals she gets in comparison to smaller zones.
- We can also come to the office to work on the data and get more of it if we need
- After the meetings, Evelyn presented us to some of her colleagues who all knew about us
- Ahmadou's email: Ahmadou.mariko@nycha.nyc.gov; phone: 718-218-1531

REES Staff Meeting

March 9, 2018, duration: 1.5 hours

Eric, Claudio, Nuriani, Tiffany

- Different sectors present. A representative of each sector gives an update with main achievements in numbers of the previous month
 1. Intake, outreach team: (1500 phone calls, 8 info sessions)
 2. Job Generation team
 3. SYP
 4. Zones (199 referrals in February)
 5. AB & FL
 6. RBO
 7. Sandy
- Then there is the opportunity to give shout-outs. The atmosphere is very appreciative and after every shout-out everyone claps.
- After that, the interns are asked to come to the front and present themselves. People ask questions. They seem very interested. One major concern is the inclusion of residents' opinions in the report, especially those who have not participated in any REES activities

St Nicks Alliance Info Session

April 18, 2018, duration: 35 minutes

Nuriani

In a classroom with 16 students (2 white, 1 Latino, 13 Black; 3 women). One staff member who gives handed out information sheets and talks about the trainings St Nicks offers. She speaks loudly and seems very strict. She says that St Nicks aim is to get the people a job. There is "no pick and choose", the attendees can pick one training in the area they choose. After that, they are not allowed to take any other training with St Nicks. They do not want people who collect licences/trainings, but they want to help people get a job and work.

1. Training: ERT. Environmental Remediation Technician
 - 30 hours, 6 weeks, Mo-Fr, 8:30-4:30
 - OSHA licensing
 - Soft skill training
 - St Nicks helps to get a job and gives attendees . They support them for one year, give them a metrocard after first paycheck
 - St Nicks's goal is for people who do training to work at least for one year
 - Requirement: 3-6 months experience in ERT, construction or similar field
2. Construction
 - Construction has the highest demand on the job market but it is very popular among people who want to do the trainings, too.
 - 6.5 weeks, Mo-Fr, 8:30 -4:30
 - Requirement: Tape test and interview (this seems to be a requirement for all trainings), 3-6 months experience in construction

She says that there is an interview and explains that people have to know what construction is about, people are rude, insult each other. She says, once a person in an interview said: 'as long as people talk respectfully to me, everything is ok.' and she said that's not what construction is. So you have to know if it's for you.

3. CDL, Commercial Driver's Licence
 - 3 week soft skills, Mo-Fr, 8:30-11:30
 - 20 hours instruction in bus + road test
 - Requirements: permit, licence 40-110 (?), have regular licence for 3 years
 - St Nicks reimburses the attendees for permit

The people ask a lot of questions. The next construction workshop starting April 30, which most of the people present are interested in, is already full and there is a wait list. People ask if they can also be put on the waitlist. Other questions are about the reimbursements and rules about absences.

The St Nicks Alliance worker attaches a lot of importance on attendance and explains that people can be removed from the training if they are constantly late or do not come to the sessions because future employees will ask about that.

After all the questions have been answered (after about 35 minutes), the Tape test can be taken. Some people leave, most stay and some people enter who had been at an info session before and only want to take the test (again). They have 2 hours for the test. There are 50 questions reading and 90 questions math.

4. Interview Guidelines

4.1. Interview Guideline for Partners

A. Basic Information

- How long have you been a partner?
- What made you partner with NYCHA-REES?
- What services do you offer to NYCHA-REES?
- How long have you personally been working with REES?
- How many NYCHA-residents have used your services through the REES-partnership? (If you know)
- Could you describe the process involved in offering your services? (From referral/first contact until the provision of the service)
- How many of the employees in your organization/department/team work with REES?
Approximately how many hours per week do they work on REES-related tasks?

B. NYCHA's Residents

- Could you describe a phone call with NYCHA-residents?
What are your experiences with those phone calls?
What are the major issues for residents? What are your major challenges?
- What are your perceptions of NYCHA's participants? And did your perceptions of them change over time?
- Do you have specific qualities that you look for when selecting NYCHA applicants to enroll in your service(s)?
- Generally speaking, would you say you have more positive or negative experience with NYCHA residents?

C. Implementation & Monitoring

- How would you define a successful service provision?
- In your opinion, how well did the partnership achieve its immediate objectives?
- How do you assess the success of your service?
 - How many REES referrals do you work with in comparison to the total amount of people you regularly serve?

D. Communication Channels

- How and how often do you communicate with REES staff? With whom, in regular intervals? (How often do you hold meetings and is there active participation from both ends?)
- What are your communication channels with REES and are they documented?
- If feedback is given from participating members to REES, does REES share that information with you, and vice versa? How?
- Are the outcome data of NYCHA participants shared with or reported to REES? How?

E. Partnership Vision & Expectations

- Do you have a common vision with NYCHA-REES?

- What does NYCHA-REES expect from you and this partnership and what are your expectations?
- How would you describe your role in relation to NYCHA-REES role?
- How is decision making done? In terms of how to improve the program and identify resources? Does REES inform you of any revisions or suggestions on the project?
- Has your role or that of NYCHA-REES been altered at any point since the beginning of the partnership?
- All in all, how satisfied are you with the partnership?

F. Sustainability & Challenges

- What enabling factors have contributed to the success of the project?
- What are the challenges in getting NYCHA-residents to make an appointment/ to come to an appointment?
- How do you think the overall project could be improved? What would you change to improve this partnership?

Specific Questions for each partner

- We noticed... Could you explain?
- What are reasons why residents do not make appointments?/do not attend appointments?
- **St. Nicks Alliance** - For employment assistance, which of your services/programs have been the most popular with REES referrals?
- **OBT** offers several services for 16-24yr olds, what challenges are specific to this demographic that differ from older residents?
- **Bedford Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation** - Your referral to appointments made ratio is above average compared to other REES partners in this zone, what would you say helps BSRC achieve that?

4.2. Interview Guideline for Zone Coordinator

A. General Questions

- How long have you been a zone coordinator?
- Please list your main tasks linked to referrals.
- How do you maintain partnerships with organizations that are REES referral partners?
- Is there a quota contract (or a similar binding agreement) with NYCHA on how many residents REES has to refer?

B. NYCHA's Residents and Developments

- What are the number of residents in each development?
- What are the forms of spreading information about the existence of partners' services available to the residents?
 - Are these forms standardized and uniform across all developments?
If not, how are the differences determined?
- How would you describe the cooperation with property managers?
 - What are the mechanisms to get property managers to collaborate with REES?
- What do you think the cause of the disparity between developments are? (In terms of the number of people getting services)

- When did the process of privatization in Zone 5 start? How does it affect residents? What have you learned from other zones where the process of privatization is more advanced? What are the repercussions?

C. Partnership Vision & Implementation

- How do you select the partners to work with? Any specific qualities you look for?
 - Does REES take heavy weight and consideration about working with partners that provide mentor/ tutor youth programs for youths residing in these developments?
- How do you track progress of beneficiaries (NYCHA residents)? Do you feel this method could be improved? If so, how?
- Has REES revised the program to cater to current events and to optimize success? If so, how?
- What would you change to improve partnerships?

D. Communication Channels

- How often do you hold meetings with partners and is there active participation from both ends? Specifically for OBT/St Nicks ALLiance/Bed-Stuy Restoration?
- Do you have clearly documented communication channels?
- Does REES inform the partner of any revisions or suggestions on the project?
- If feedback is given from participating residents to REES, does REES share that information with the partner, and vice versa? How?

E. Sustainability & Challenges

- In your opinion, how well did the referral partnership project achieve its immediate objectives?
 - How would you rate the success of St.Nicks Alliance/OBT/Bed-Stuy Restoration? Why?
- What enabling factors have contributed to the success of the project?
- What are the challenges you/REES face while coordinating services?
- What does the data leave out from the referral numbers?
- What different service gaps do you notice among the different partnerships?
- What specific challenges do you see for the respective partner OBT/Bed-Stuy Restoration/ St Nicks Alliance?

5. Form of Consent for Interviews



Form of Consent

I, _____, am participating in **an interview with a student/students from The New School as part of their project on REES and REES partnerships in the course *Urban Poverty and Inequality*.**

To that end, it is my understanding that they will record this interview for educational purposes.

The interview will be transcribed and analyzed by the students. It will be attached to the students' report, which is the final product of their project.

I understand and agree that citations from my interview may be included in the students' report and presentations.

I hereby grant permission to use the audio recording of me,

☐ with my name and information about me.

☐ without my name and information about me.

I shall have no claim against The New School or any other person, firm, or corporation by reason of any such use of my name, voice or information about me as described above, whether alone or in conjunction with others. I hereby release The New School from any such claims.

I waive any right or option to inspect or approve the finished product or other copy that may be used along with this recording, my name or information about me as described above. I understand that The New School shall have sole discretion to decide whether to use my voice or information about me.

I represent that I am free to enter into this agreement. I have read the foregoing and fully and completely understand the contents thereof.

Signature

Name (Please Print)

Date

6. Interview Transcripts

6.1. Interview St Nicks Restoration Alliance

April 18, 2018. Interviewer: Nuriani Hamdan, duration: 45 min.

Consent: yes, name may be included

Giselle Ramos (GR): My name is Giselle Ramos, the outreach coordinator for first development in st. nicks alliance (SNA). SNA started a little over 40 years in the 70's as a housing preservation, tenant advocate, considered grassroots organization non-profit. So, what they did was they became advocates and fighters people who were being threatened out of their home or displaced out of their homes any means necessary by slumlords. So they built an organization they started out of the basement of a church, that's where SNA comes from. then moving slowly but surely, as they got they expanded they worked with community organization in the Williamsburg Greenpoint section because that's how it started, so they got together with the legal aid society for tenants and the Italian American Association, the Puerto Rican family institutes and they built this st nicks alliance. so they started to grow and meet and helping family, they also noticed there were issues with literacy, with gaining employment, and they branched out our housing assistance, elder care, elder sustained living, youth programs employment services, adult education programs and that's where I came to this. What I do, is that I set up appointments, I attend meetings, community board meetings, community council meetings, I also go around doing presentations of the programs that we offer, that they are all free, we would like to encourage residents within our Williamsburg, Bushwick, Bed-Stuy community to get everything that we could offer within an allotted time. So if we have a participant that has to get his High School equivalency, we encourage him to do that, if he could go to school at 9 and do a training in the morning for an employment we also offer that as well. I myself I am a product of Fort Force development I came here 10-8 years ago as a student, I came here in 2010, got my HS equivalency, started as an evening receptionist, the director at the time kinda saw a gift of talking and explaining it, not just talking, but I related to people and I was able to explain and look at that relationship rather than help them apply for the program. So what I do, is I now go to schools, I go to HRA offices where they do group information sessions, I go to prisons, I've gone to three correctional facilities in NY, I've gone to edgecombe(?), I've gone to Queens borough and I'm going to Lincoln --- correctional facility that is in Harlem -- and again we meet like organizations like HRA, we partner with other organizations, we've done job and job fare and job recruitments, I'm the one that does the outreach for it. It's, I'm the middle man of the program.

Nuriani (NR): Where does the partnership with REES fit in?

GR: So I wanna vice executive director Jose Leon, felt that we needed an extra link with NYCHA. NYCHA is a really organized organization or entity that you cannot just walk in, you have to be invited. So we found REES and Evelyn Melendez as the coordinator, the community coordinator through the NYCHA, and under her belt she hold 32 buildings or 32 houses, and most of those houses I work with, so I needed that person to say "well she's our partner, this is what we offer, she could come here to the tenant associations meetings, and od presentations if you like" I basically go to the management office,

drop off flyers, I walk through the NYCHA buildings and hand off flyers. If I feel it is necessary to build up programs. Sadly that a lot of people that live in this area that is like about 9 nycha houses just in this immediate area, that don't even know that we exist, and when they see me then they are "where are you located" -- "right up the block from Fred Albert" so they are like "really" and i'm like "yep". This is how it works. I believe that you should be constant in your outreach and community service, that they need to know that yes you come from this community, and talk about it all the time. I could be standing on the bus stop, and if someone says "you work for SNA" I'm like "yeah, this is what we offer" and I always walk around with a stack of flyers. yeah I am that person. Because there should not be a reason, you cannot say that there is not enough, that there isn't any, the commitment of the program. Is ok for me to tell you that I have all this certifications, can you do the training 6 weeks, Monday through Friday. I have build a pretty good relationship with my community leaders, one because i'm also a constituent to the community of the community, and two because im generally concerned of the well-being of my residents, the same thing that I offer is a consistency and it's a pride and drive that I have, and mostly people that work here have that same effect, because we come from humble beginnings but similar backgrounds so we understand that. New Yorkers don't want to hear about it, ---- we want you to do it, like "hey, this is what we have to offer, does it work for you" or "what is it that you want to do". Because if i don't have it, I'll definitely have a program that will, I'll definitely find another organization that will. I'm not gonna leave this person hanging dry.

NR: how do you get in touch with NYCHA residents, is it through flyers as you mentioned?

GR: it's usually through flyers, most of the time is through the tenant association, but I usually speak with the panel and they'll send people to me. If I have at least one or two more people that I could use, we start flyer building. We have to flyer those that have the NYCHA emblem on, to let them know that we are partners with them. we also get referrals through their kiosk, we have a little kiosk, so we get like a little referral notification, and we go down the line, letting them know that we have programs available, that are gonna be starting soon, or the next cycle. Sometimes they come in, sometimes they don't. They sound really enthused in the very beginning, and guess is just fear of "is it worth it, is it true", it's too good to be true kinda thing. So they get a little leery about it. But if they keep seeing me, they know that i'm real, they know that what i offer is real.

NR: I someone refers a NYCHA resident to SNA, you make a call to that resident.

GR: Right, if it's through the NYCHA-REES referral their contact info is in there. If let say that the tenant association president from the Sumner houses says "I have a young man here, who is interested in the skills training and the constructions" I am like "what's this person's name, is he there? what's his phone number? does he want to come see me? I'll be waiting for him" If he doesn't, I'll say i'll call him or he will and we set an appointment. That's usually how it works.

NR: You mention that people are enthusiastic at first...

GR: Like at first it sounds really good "yeah I want that", but when they read they see that it's a six-week training, it's from 8:30 to 4:40 five days out of the week, that's a lot, they are just expecting to get their certifications and look for work, and in our training its not only just getting their certification, its getting them job readings, so we do a two week intense job readiness 101, we build their resume, we add the certifications to their resumes, we have mock interview. Then when we feel like they are job ready we send them off on interviews. Because even if its construction, a contract manager wants to meet them, wants to see that they are dressed, wants to see that they have right resume and the certifications are

up to date, and they need to get an understanding that it is a hard job. So we want to prepare them, we don't want to set them up for failure, we want success stories.

NR: Are you looking for a specific qualities in NYCHA residents?

GR: The two things that I look for is punctuality and attendance. Everything else should come easy. I want your time and your day time.

NR: And do you have the impression that NYCHA residents have those qualities?

GR: It's a touch and go with them because you have people in NYCHA that have been dictated and hassle and hustled, so they have that mentality, that I have to lead them. Here at SNA, we want them to know that. They can make these decisions, we are willing to back them up if they want to make these decisions. we usually catch on to young adults or to adults that feel like they think they are gonna do it, but we could see, and maybe this is much of a strain for you before we sign you up. because for those signing every individual, for example, we got constructions, offers a 30 hour OSHA, a flagger, a scaffolding, a fireguard 60, a core training which is them to work as a team, them to build a team, them to demolish as a team, to get used to knowing that everything is a team effort, especially on the construction site, they all work together. You might think that they are not doing something, but they are all together, each one of them has something to do. We want them to get into that mentality. If I see, I got a feeling that one of them or some of them don't have that, maybe this is not for you, maybe you just need an employment service, that is just into educating resume building. we try to get a feel because again, we don't want to turn them away. And some of the participants have had zero knowledge of work ethics or work readiness, so rather get them into that, make sure that they are comfortable in that, if they want to evolve and do this ----- that's my task. That's basically how I do it.

NR: Do you have an overview of how many NYCHA residents get referred by REES?

GR: [starts responding before questions is completed] So I get about 25 to 40 a month. Out of the 25 to 40, I probably will get 15 to 16 that will stay and complete the training... Let's not do math. But it's more or less that.

NR: Do you know how many of those are referred by REES?

GR: I show you what a REES file looks like. [Goes on the computer to show me referral page]. So this is what it looks like. So you see the employment assessments, then you have employment, adult education, so and then it also gives you the dates it was sent to us. So these are all open. So then if I haven't called these people up, so when I call them I will leave a note: appointment was made, number was wrong, call back again, number was wrong. Then I'll put in a feed ... let's say ... so her number is not receiving calls, I'll give it another try, if the number is not working, then what I'll do is, come down here and say 'unresponsive'. I'm not gonna say 'not interested', I'm gonna say 'unresponsive' and it kicks it out. So I get about 25 a month of these but for employment because we have different kinds. We have for adult education and employment. Because that's it. It doesn't say that we're skills training, it's not that advanced, though we would love it to be that we because sometimes... I don't have a problem talking to them, finding out what it is that they wanna know, but sometimes, if me, the program manager from employment services and adult education and skills training. So skills training coordinator sees employment assistance, she's not gonna ask, what is it that you're interested in, she

doesn't wanna hear that. If it said something to the effect of 'skills training, vocational training', then she'll say: Listen, this is what we have to offer. So each one has an aspect of what to say. To them, it's a waste of their time. For me, I can sit here and I'll evaluate it, because that's what I do. So that's basically yeah. I get like about 25 of them and then I'll just, who has attended an appointment, who has ever made an appointment, who was ever closed out because they either said they weren't interested or sometimes they're very rude. Yeah, sometimes they take pleasure of being rude and these are the ones that are open. So you know, I try to be as cordial as I can. Not overly friendly because I think that annoys people. But I'm like 'Hey you, you filled out a flyer, or you know you filled out a voucher and I just wanna know what is it that you're interested in? And then if I see that they haven't responded, I'm like 'Hey, what is it? Were you not interested? Did you show up? How did it go' Sometimes I'm like 'I'm just not... I'm just not interested' and they hang up the phone. Not interested, ok. I give it that way. Whatever what was going on that day at that time, they were bothered by it, so hey. Because we don't know. We don't know why they.. I don't take it personally. If I did But. Ok, sometimes they call me back. 'I spoke to you the other day' I'm like 'yeah, you kinda hung up on me' and she yeah, sorry about that. Ok. And when they meet me and what they hear and what they see are two different things and that's a big... I'm like 'you ok now?' It's a colorful and rewarding job and I really do it because I enjoy my community. And once it starts to get warmer, I look for every excuse to go outside. You want me to go to a meeting? Yeah ok! Any excuse, I cease it. And I like it because I like meeting people and some of them will say 'oh I went there one time and you guys gave me a hard time' and I'm like, what was it? What was it that you didn't do? Or what was it that you thought was hard? Because this is what we do. We just wanna make sure that you're gonna do it. 'Oh, because I had a Pennsylvania license...' I say, that's the thing, you have to be a New York resident. You have to show prove. You have to have a valid ID. 'Oh, I showed them my EBT card'. That's just telling me that you're receiving benefits, that doesn't tell me that you live in NY. Because I could live in California and still use my EBT from NY, so. So you know things like that. 'Oh you know, a lot has changed, we do a better assessment, lalalalala', that kind of stuff

NR: I feel like it depends a lot on your personal commitment to get people to come and get the services they really need.

GR: Mhm. Well not just the personal commitment. It's like, you can't complain that you're not going anywhere and then I show you what you have, what we have and you're making excuses. You can't complain, because then you should just stop complaining.

NR: But also on ...

GR: On my personal level? Yeah! Yeah, I like. Yeah, because I lost my job in 2008. And I didn't have a high school diploma. I worked the better part of my life, made pretty good money. But what my last job entailed, the computer system was antiquated. I worked in the garment industry and I worked for a family that would not move forward in technology. Because they thought that the way things were working, it was fine and didn't need to change. And orders were being lost, stuff was being cancelled, orders were being cancelled, doubled. To do an inventory, that meant manually I had to go down and get it. So because you didn't wanna update it. So when I finally lost my job, I came here, they were offering computer system, basic WINDOWS, which I was loving. I was like Oh my God. My screen was green! It was Lotus 1 and 2! You ever remember Lotus? It was scary? Ok it was 2000, it was the 21st century and my screen was green. So I did that and I did my High School equivalency. The job developer read my resume. I worked in the showroom, I worked in this and that so they were like, Oh so you have reception and some business background. So I started out as a evening receptionist, working

at night for adult education. Again, my director was very interested how I interacted with humans, with other participants and she said: So how about... Then the first outreach I ever did was for DACA. [.....] So then from there, my boss liked again how I related so he had me do more work with the people from NYCHA. So again NYCHA is veery if you are not from NYCHA, if you are not from the neighborhood, if somebody doesn't know who you are, that's why it's always important to do the outreach tenant association present [unclear]. That's why it's always good to speak with people, especially seniors who live there and have been there for a long time and know things and they'll say, well come to my church, or come to the tenant, I'm gonna introduce you. And that's how you get in. Because they're an elder, they will respect what this elder has to say and then they'll say well if she says she's legitimate, let's see what we could do, let's see what we could offer. For adults and for youth. And here I am.

NR: You've been working with REES since the beginning of the partnership as far as I understand.

GR: Yes. That's been going on for three years now. As soon as we became partners. Well, happy anniversary! And it's been good. I learned a lot from Evelyn. I learned a lot from NYCHA. It's like I said, it's a different entity

NR: Have there been any changes during that time?

GR: With the exception of our curriculum changing, our certifications, I think our relationship is really good. We've done a few resource fares. We're doing a breakfast networking. REES is invited. I'm a great believer that, cause I believe that if there's a common cause it can affect everything. And she is honored by us, Evelyn. She's being honored partner of the year or something. It's gonna be on the 5th of May. So after the Marathon, she's going to be awarded. She's very good at what she does.

NR: So are you mostly in contact with Evelyn or any other REES staff?

GR: Mostly in contact with Evelyn because she's our community liaison coordinator for this area. But I've also worked with Jobs Plus in the Bed-Stuy, Brownsville area. The NYCHA houses in that area in Brooklyn and I actually think it was through one of her coworkers and they had me go there. And I did the same thing, it was outreach. It was through another organization but they kind of offer what we offer. So we refer them out. If we have people that come all the way from Brownsville here and it's too much for them, I call and I tell them, I have this gentleman, he is a NYCHA resident, he is looking for this particular training, they say, well send them down. We do that. We do phone calls, we like to do a lot of email referrals, because we like to keep track of the stuff that's going on. That makes sense for networking purposes.

NR: Do you have any institutionalized meetings with REES?

GR: No. What we like to do, is a few months out of the year, we want to secure a certain number of dates to go to the actual NYCHA office to do presentations there in the Atlantic Office. And we do like every other week or like three to six months, depending on what the population is. And like everything else: Things that are getting close to school years are starting to die down because people are focusing on getting their kids ready for school. Then it'll build up a little bit but then it'll die down again in November and December because again now people will stop looking for employment and are focusing on, I guess, gifts and stuff like that and however they yeah. And then it'll peak again after New Year's and it'll stay peaking until summer and it'll slow down again. That's what I've noticed since I've

gone out. So I work with them. So right now is a perfect time to get people to sign up for the construction labor because employment is going to start booming. And environmental.

NR: What are challenges you see in the partnership and in the work with the residents?

GR: Well, the only thing I have an issue with the partnership, is the referral system. Because it's just two categories. And it's hard to elaborate what a resident really wants into two categories. I would love to see their referral system updated to employment service, adult education and *vocational training programs*. It doesn't have to be that specific. Most households, on their lease it shows how many kids they have. It shows if they have any young adults. So we want to target that also. I want to say, one time she did an amazing favor for us. We were pushing for the greenscaping. We were targeting certain areas in our contract zone and she made it her business to get the addresses of the two NYCHA houses that we felt was going to work. And we did envelope and we did mailing and we got the paper cuts to prove it. And the one thing that didn't work with us, was the weather. Because when we started it was a beautiful day and we had seven participant come in, residents from NYCHA. It was the Bushwick and Sumner houses. And seven people came in and then the weather came, the storms came and nobody came out. And we couldn't get in contact with them because we didn't keep the list, she did. So then what I would do, during the storm, I would go to the community centers and to the housing offices and drop off flyers as much as I could so we were able to get the class started. The greenscaping is taught through the Botanical Garden, it's really nice. The kids are learning a lot. The age is 18 to 24.

So yeah, the only challenge I would feel is that they need to update, to be a little more specific in their referral listing. That's probably it. Other than that I think with REES I have a great partnership, a great relationship. With residents again, I think it's building trust with people because again, they're so used to be treated in a ways that they believe they should be treated or act all the time. So it's that first impression. It's not easy the first try. You run up to people who are very hesitant. And they're gonna be challenging because it's an insecurity that they have and we understand it. It's just to not lose patience. And be totally honest. Because if you're totally honest with what you sell, they're gonna respect that from you. Never easy but it's the most I can give.

NR: And maybe the last question: Which of your programs or services have been most popular?

GR: Construction! Construction labor by far. It's construction labor, CDL and environmental is the last. But it's construction labor, CDL and employment services. Because people come with certifications and they want just direct hire. But we don't like to send anybody out unless they have some kind of coaching, training in interview etiquette and stuff. But it's really construction labor. And I understand why. And now that we recently updated our OSHA certification from ten hour to 30 hour, that's a better pay. Just in that alone, it's a better pay. So if you are familiar with OSHA certification...

NR: Yeah. Alright, OSHA training just teaches you basic safety. If you walk into a construction sight, you have to have a hardhat on. You have to have protective eyewear, you have to have a reflective jacket, proper boots, proper clothings, not sweatpants, like good denim, like good... like have you ever seen those guys with those heavy brown jumpers? That by far is the best thing. It's a little expensive but it's tear-resistant. The steel toe shoes, or now they don't want you to use steel toe boots, they want you to use reinforced fiberglass, the rubber has a specific coding to it, like if there's an electrical wire or something and it touches water, it runs the ground so that you don't get electrocuted. And it's personal safety, that's what it is. So the 30 hour not only deals with personal safety, it also deals with how you handle other equipments, the rigors, the scaffolding, the cranes, the elevators, power tools, cement

mixing, that you use safely at all times and using all of these equipments. So that's basically what the 30 hours is. So a person has to have at least 3 to 6 months of construction experience because usually I get a young man saying I wanna do construction because his friends doing it and he has no clue how heavy, how tedious this job is. And construction starts as early as 5 in the morning. You might end early but construction starts as early as 5 in the morning. So you do drug testing here. It's not like, if you don't pass a drug test, we're gonna throw you out but let's consider it. So usually when we give the information session, we like to let them know from the very beginning, from this point on, if they want to get a chance into this program, they have to stop thinking about recreational, just leave it on the back for a little while. And that's basically yeah.

NR: Do you keep track of the people who went through your trainings and then get a job?

GR: Yeah we do for retention purposes. We keep track of them for two whole years. We try to do an alumni monthly or I don't know if it's quarterly ... I think it's every 6 months. We like people to come in and speak with our participants that are in the class. We do have employers come in and we have employers come in and talk about how they want the program to work for them. We want them to succeed and some of them get interviewed right then and there. And if [unclear] they get hired and start the next day. They give everybody an opportunity so it shouldn't be. And some of them get overwhelmed. 'We started but it was too hard'.

NR: Do you give those records to REES?

GR: No. These are private records. We do invite them for the graduation if there are some participants that are from REES. We invite them to come in. We've done a few programs through NYCHA. We've done the pest control and we've done the first cohort of construction labor for NYCHA. So we've had a relationship. And I think that's how José decided to do that REES partnership with the NYCHA residents, with NYCHA and us because of the other trainings that we offered.

6.2. Interview with Opportunities for a Better Tomorrow

April 19, 2018, Interviewer: Eric Capina, duration: 1 hour.

Interview answers were transcribed from handwritten notes because the interviewees were unable to get authorization from their supervisors for a recorded interview.

The interviews did not give consent to use their names.

NG and ET were previously in a meeting 2 months ago with Evelyn Melendez, Zone Coordinator of Zone 5. The meeting purpose was to address OBT's lack of referral connections and closings. Previously a single OBT staff member was in charge of processing all REES referral requests, NG and ET were brought on to evenly disperse the workload.

EC: How long have you been a partner?

NG & ET: We're unable to give an accurate answer to that because we're both new to working with REES' referral system. ING is also still relatively new in his role with OBT, joining the organization in

November '16] We recommend referring to Emily Hills, Director of Outreach & Community Partnerships for an accurate history of the partnership [Emily was also the OBT staff member interviewed last year].

EC: Since you're unable to speak on the origins of the partnership, why would you say OBT continues to partner with REES?

NG: Our missions align. It also comes down to our passion to serve communities in need and help change lives. We provide temporary assistance for needy families and a lot of NYCHA residents qualify for our programs. Our service outcomes matter as well. OBT relies on tracking their work in order to receive financial support as a non-profit organization. REES helps provide OBT with people to serve and support.

EC: What services do you offer to NYCHA-REES?

NG: OBT offers programs in High School equivalency, job readiness, financial literacy, and ESOL (English for Speakers of Other Languages). Our office (280 Wyckoff Ave) only works with Adult Education programs, for anyone older than 21 years of age.

ET: We also offer immigrant services through our Office of New Americans. We assist people with naturalization, citizenship processes and more.

EC: How long have you personally been working with REES?

NG & ET: We both have been working with REES ever since our referral system training meeting with Evelyn. [approximately 2 months at the time of the interview]

EC: How many NYCHA-residents have used your services through the REES-partnership? (If you know).

NG: We're unsure of any numbers previous to us taking on our work with the REES partnership. Emily would be able to find out that information.

ET: Since starting my work with REES, we haven't had any of our contacted referrals arrive to their appointments at our Friday information sessions.

EC: Could you describe the process involved in offering your services? (From referral/first contact until the provision of the service)

ET: Referrals are processed from the referral system shared with REES. From there each resident is called and invited to a weekly info session on Fridays at OBT. Residents are asked to register via phone or email, upon registration residents are considered to have an appointment made.

NG: We use our Salesforce system [a customer relationships management platform] to track the impact of our services. Including: attendance, education, employment, etc.

EC: Do you know how much of that information is shared with REES?

NG: I am unsure, you would need to refer to Emily for that.

EC: How many of the employees in your organization/department/team work with REES? Approximately how many hours per week do they work on REES-related tasks?

NG: I do not know the exact number, but I would estimate that OBT has about 100 staff members. We have 4 staff currently supporting our partnership with REES, including myself and ET.

ET: I personally work on the REES referral system on Fridays which are my administrative work days. I spend a lot of time on trying to close referrals from the backlog prior to our meeting with Evelyn.

NG: I should also mention that our staff member who originally worked with the referral system on their own prior to our meeting is no longer with OBT.

EC: Could you describe a phone call with NYCHA-residents? What are the major issues for residents? What are your major challenges?

ET: I start with an introduction, "Hi this is ET from OBT contacting regarding your referral request". From there I invite them to our info session on Fridays, if they confirm I input it as an appointment made. We haven't experienced any major issues with residents yet, mostly because it is still early in our work with the referrals.

EC: What happens during a general weekly intake session?

ET: We conduct equivalency testings and we recommend specific services based on the test results. We use Tests of Adult Basic Education (TABE). The locator portion of the tests assess the participants' English and Math skills. After the locator exam, there is a specialized test in these three subjects: reading, math computation, and applied mathematics. If anyone scores below a 6th grade level we unfortunately can't serve them, but we offer them another chance to retake the exams.

EC: How would you define a successful service provision?

NG: "When the person gets enrolled". Once the referral is made it is a success and up to the person's choice - as long as we hear from them.*****

EC: What are the challenges in getting NYCHA residents and other community members to make an appointment and attend it?

NG: Motivation is really important. In the classes I teach I try hard

EC: How many REES referrals do you work with in comparison to the total amount of people you regularly serve?

NG: Compared to the non-REES people I can't say for sure right now. The data is available, I just need time to collect it from our system.

EC: How and how often do you communicate with REES staff? With whom, in regular intervals? (How often do you hold meetings and is there active participation from both ends?)

NG & ET: Prior to starting our work with the REES partnership we can't say how often communication was made. We have not had any communication with REES staff since our initial referral system training meeting.

EC: What are your communication channels with REES and are they documented?

NG: We do have an open communication with REES. In most of our emails everyone involved is always CC'd. When necessary we hold meetings as you saw.

EC: Has your role or that of NYCHA-REES been altered at any point since the beginning of the partnership?

NG & ET: We now have shared roles in our work with the partnership, changing from only one staff member working with REES.

EC: All in all, how satisfied are you with the partnership?

NG: We're very satisfied with constant flow of referrals to our services. We're grateful for the technology of the referral system for making the process easier. ****

6.3. Interview with Bedford-Stuyvesant Restoration Corporation

April 19, 2018. Interviewer: Tiffany Jonassen, duration: 1.5 hours.

Consent: yes, name may be included

Tiffany: how long has this been a partner with REES?

Stephanie: I've been here for almost 3 years and it's been together from way before I was here so I'm assuming what since we started maybe 10 years

Tiffany: did you know what made restoration partner with REES?

Stephanie: I think that we have the same mission and we are both organizations about helping communities and low income families with opportunities they may not necessarily know they have so I think that's why we probably came together

Tiffany: In contrast to if Restoration was on its own, what do you think are the benefits of partnering up with a city organization like REES?

Stephanie: Cause we're all city organization- I think that the more people we reach out to the better so there may be in REES and NYCHA set of people they help and assist the more we help the better

Tiffany: so it's reaching a greater mass

Stephanie: mhmm

Tiffany: do you think the effectiveness of providing services are the same whether it's a smaller institution or whether you reach out more people? or do you have the capacity to like..

Stephanie: I think we do have the capacity yes- we help more people yes, I think how can I say -- I do think we have the capacity - I think with the partnership we do have the capacity

Tiffany: Could you tell me the order of the most asked services from you guys?

Stephanie: we have so many services -- I mean it ranges ; it depends on the year too; it depends on the time of the year according to what people are looking for — for instance we just had tax season so everyone wanted their taxes done we had all these clients for taxes there, and times during the holidays about jobs and getting a job because you know holidays are coming some people want money and stuff like that but some it's Financial counseling so it's all different than the times of the year I know that beside taxes when it's tax season we get a lot of employment and a lot of SNAP clients; a lot of clients that need jobs and a lot of clients that need benefits those are the two highest

Tiffany: You think you got more residences based on referrals or them calling you for help first?

Stephanie: I think we get a lot of clients from REES - a lot from REES but we get a lot of clients walk-ins we are on different websites

[**Chancellor** (second interviewee comes in -- GREETINGS)]

Tiffany: What do you think the most common way is for the residents to know about this- like through advertisements — which is the way they hear about this the most?

Stephanie we do a lot of Outreach I know that there's times that we have our 30 people that work with us that hand out flyers and we have different events we also have like a newsletter that goes out to our clients and we have events again - he posts on Facebook sometimes and Instagram

Chancellor: restoration uses Instagram and Twitter to get the word out. Word of Mouth-- sometimes especially during the summer we have our own table in front of the center so then people who's walking through the crowd the right here

Tiffany: we looked at a lot of the data how appointments are made and we were curious about the protocols and who makes the calls when They get referrals just that whole process

Chancellor: well it is an effort so we check in with everyday to see who is calling well I call most all the time because I just happened to do it but it's just who I am ever, everyone in the front knows how to use it so

Stephanie: we all have access to the email if there is a new client or an outstanding client this person has made a call what is the status on we all have access to that he does the majority of the calls But if there is a time where he cannot do it- if someone speaks Spanish or another language or we're not able to reach them, we will try to send them an email or try to call them or try to call her and ask her if there is anything we can do so we try to reach them as much as we can in different ways

Tiffany: Can you specify the front line you just mentioned

Chancellor: so as you came in this morning that front desk area that is the customer service team that uses that space so myself Stephanie Shana we all have access to it to the computers so it's basically just picking it up checking picking it up and calling

Tiffany: so it's about 3?

Stephanie: it's three of us - All the time there is two people in the front usually it's Shana and Chancellor in the front I have my own cubicle in the back he has his own cubicle in the back also so whatever we have to like move around and he has to go to lunch he has a meeting there's always someone there in the front to make sure that there's two people in the front of all times

Tiffany: and you don't think it's overwhelming like 3 people is good enough to handle that amount

Stephanie: I think we need four or five people (laughs) it gets intense because we have a lot of different contacts besides REES there is a lot of other assistance- So we have to make sure that we refer to those people too so it gets a lot but we managed

Chancellor: especially during this season from February 1st to now they're doing taxes the four people coming in it can get overwhelming but we got it but four or five people would be nice (laughs)

Tiffany: I remember I think you said there is the time frame right (looking at Evelyn)

Evelyn: when you receive the email you have 24 to 48 hours to actually respond

Tiffany: so you only have 3 people- how many contracts do you have

Stephanie: do I have -- we Could look at my computer right now; I have like 17 times open no joke; and that's each how come we tabs open to enter into cuz it's not just like I call a client and that's it it's over; no, I had to make sure I dropped down okay this client was seen on this date this client it's called for the service and there's three different trackers we have to put them onto each other okay so this contract in this contract is for CBC the contract is for XYZ; it's all just maintaining data; So it's not just say hey you have an appointment or we would like to help you now we got to make sure that we keep their information it's hot and that we have a flow of somebody called six months down the line it says hey I called 6 months ago about REES and I lost my job; we have you on our data so you won't have to restart the whole process again. it's a process (laughs)

Tiffany: I know you guys both mentioned about because of the season a lot of people called about tax but other than that is there something you guys I guess just hear the most that you can just pick out when you receive calls

Stephanie: " I need need a job"

Chancellor: Financial counseling-- I think those are the top 2

Stephanie: And SNAP - it's not like - i understand that you are an employment agency, or something like that it's " I heard you could get me a job" (with attitude) " so it's like wait now there's this process because we don't want you to fail so will say okay we are going to get you a job but if you speak to an

employer like that they're not going to hire you to get a job you got to help us so we want you to take the car so dressing up in a certain way; being successful so that when you do go get that job that you do get it; so we try to offer them other services before you get employment services because you don't know the lingo to speak with an employer; bc what happens if you go to an interview and you don't get it, you get discouraged;

Chancellor: yeah what she said; also to add on -- the time frame from not having a job

Chancellor: also, to add on that time from not having a job and having a job there are so many benefits you can receive -- and telling them about that; Especially in NY they want to get their own place and everything, carrying on to financial counseling; bc you got a job and what are you going to do with the money? you gotta know how to budget

Tiffany: Do you think people really attend these financial counseling sessions or they just sign up?

Stephanie: I think more adults 25 and older do-- because young adult don't understanding what it is to having financials intact-- they're still young going out -- they don't see the importance of fixing your credit and get your credit intact -- if you're 25 and an adult you want a car, you want a house ; you can't buy those things if you have bad credit; so we see that if it's adults over 25 they will keep it; and then will be dedicated to coming and will come 3-4 times for their sessions for their financial counseling appointments

Chancellor: yeah especially for adults, yesterday I had a lady that came for the first time and was like why haven't I known about this service before, so it's a really great thing; 25 older -- she's right. Younger; they show up these appointments because it's what people tell you- people tell you oh you need your credit score; but

Stephanie: they're not mandated; so if someone comes out of the shelter or someone has defaulted on their grant or something like that and they want a one shot deal ; HR will pay, but they'll want you to budget your finance so you won't have to come back to get a one shot deal again - so they'll send them here. they don't really understand what it is that they're getting -- the benefits that they're getting

Tiffany: Seeing all these profiles, and receiving all these calls, I'm sure there are patterns -- what do you think the main reason for all these people that call in -- it is so difficult to have the jobs they want? (Education? Incarceration? etc.)

Chancellor: I mean it can hinder, but the pattern I see it is just of not knowing (**Stephanie:** Yeah, they don't know) and that's okay, which a lot of people still don't understand, and that's okay, but now that you know, let's get you on this path

Stephanie: yeah they don't know the service; they don't feel like they can; they don't think they can succeed; maybe it's a cultural thing; it can be about their environment

Chancellor: we had this young male; he just passed away; he was coming here trying to turn his life around; and he was on the path; and just -- the environment was just --

Stephanie: he was formerly incarcerated; came out of jail trying to get his life together trying to get SNAP trying to be a good father; trying to get a job; and going to any programs he can; there would be times where he would walk in, and be really sad- would be screaming -- we say no -- calm down and

you gotta behave ; he apologizes and he would try to change that -- it was just said because of the environment he chose to live in - or not even chose to live the environment he had no choice but to live in -- it's hard; again, like he said people don't know that they can change their lives -- and we're just here to help them

Tiffany: Sorry, I'm going to ask a question a little out of this -- I went to a public high school in NJ so I don't know the system -- how high school is here; are there counselor for the youth in the public high school system

Stephanie: I went to school here; he to school in North Carolina (CH: I went to school everywhere) I went to school in Brooklyn - and in Queens. When I was in high school there were counselors; um.. I felt, and I still feel like this -- most teachers do not care. if you're in a charter school - those charter schools are absolutely great. They're probably the best thing that has happened to the system in NYC bc they really enforce school, graduating, college -becoming successful ; but public schools I don't think that most teachers care.

Chancellor: I can add on to that, but not from a NY view -- I went to 5 different high schools; in 5 different cities and 3 different states. So i've seen other schools ; and she's right -- there are a lot of teachers; not just teachers -- even staffs that really don't care; that's why people don't know anythings anymore; those resources aren't being used like out all the schools I've been to, there was on particular staff member -- just happens to be in North Carolina, it was my junior year -- he took me under his wings and showed me other resources; I would've never been on college campuses until he took - like hey you come with me -- on college campuses; we need more people like that and that's why I know about these stuff; a lot of these resources; but a lot of people don't have that opportunity

Stephanie: And there's also a lot of programs with -- this isn't the first program that they've come to -- they've gone to the HRA office which is extremely rude; they're very very rude to people; they treat people like they're garbage; they've been to other programs that haven't helped them; so when they come to us they're like 'what are you going to do that's so different" they already have that -- they're closed off -- they already have that fear, okay wait I can't trust you because I've been to other programs and they didn't help me. so how are you going to be different; so we have to as an organization prove them, okay not only we're here to help you, but we're different, and sometimes it's not easy; ughhh like let me help you; (laughs) like let me help you; but it takes us time; you know people have been through bad experiences

Chancellor: Schools and programs: there are so many different programs; bc once you do one of these programs then you can be like one of these programs helped. i went through - when i got employed i went through the workforce; and I don't think they were as useful as they could've been. If I came here -- I know that things would've been different. And I am not just saying that bc I work here -- I see how the way people here how - they have a situation going on and all the staffs are going to know. We communicate with each other when it comes to certain clients. we have a client now who's homeless, we don't want you to leave here once you're done with the program not to -- we want to make sure you're set off for success.

Stephanie: And maybe if had clients come in hungry, and there's another; not just me, not just chancellor, other staff members - you know here's a dollar, two dollars, get this cuz you know we're an organization, and we cannot say that our mission is to help the community and help people and when someone is here that needs help, we just turn our backs -- it doesn't work that way.

21:56 (me talking - skip)

Stephanie: And it's not just the youth, I mean it's the parents, and the grandparents, they don't know either.

Chancellor: Yeah, there are people in their 40s, and 50s and not seeing this type service before

Stephanie: I mean we have clients that are 42, 43 years old that come in with a cellphone, and they're like I don't know what to do with it. And it's like I guess yeah you're 40s, but you should want to learn these things -- skip -- we say okay there is this program go here, they don't know, they don't know anything, they don't know where to look for to get those services

Chancellor: Especially in this community just asking for help is the most difficult thing to do. You're struggling, you have to work, you have to do this

Stephanie: You have to be proud. and even if we tell them, don't be proud, it's okay to ask for help there's nothing wrong with that; --skip (C2C: Connection to Care, mental care initiatives - sit down with them - crying 24:28)

Tiffany: You mentioned, people not being able to use their phones, not having access to computers; do you think the majority of clients here don't have access to computers

Stephanie: We have a computer lab here. So from 10-4 everyday the computer lab is available to anyone in the community, they have to come in, print out a paper, work on a resume, even if they just want to watch youtube 25:08

Tiffany: How about smartphones?

Chancellor: I think it's client by client; a lot of them do have smartphones; certain clients don't and some are not really handy

Stephanie: (telling a story about teaching someone how to use phone 26:38)

Tiffany: Approximately how many people do you guys serve per year?

Stephanie & Chancellor: Whoo that's a lot of people -

Stephanie: I mean a lot of people; also like we can see from January 28th is when taxes started into April 18th, which was yesterday; we were open 7 days a week, and we saw about 125 clients per day. JUST for taxes -- that's not adding the other services -- that's not adding financial counseling; SNAP; and it's like 3 of us, and we're here all day long 27:46 -- and we have 10 tax preparers ; and we have financial services team; employment team; educational services team; entrepreneurship; we have the C2C team; so it's like a madhouse you run around all day long

Chancellor: We have an outside company come in - we just let them use the space, and we promote the service; not in-house all year around; only during tax season;

Evelyn: It's a vita privatized pilot program 29:23 -- with Food Bank, they provide the retired licensed accountant that can do tax preparation free of charge to the community.

Stephanie: (Skip- Tax; "Self-Prep" do their own taxes - tax preparer; or Vita; or one on one) 30:45

Evelyn: 32:04 Tax - community resources explanation

Stephanie: (explaining more tax) 33:25

Tiffany: But the number you told me, is that only the population of Bed Stuy?

Stephanie: No no no, from everywhere; it can be from (talking all at the same time 34:03 it's a city-wide partnership; some people come from the Bronx.

Stephanie: We have a floater 34:40 data entry (skip)
(Chancellor works until 9 PM)

Chancellor: It's worse than the DMV

Tiffany: What is the HRA?

All three: Human Resource Administration

Tiffany: Is that part of the city?

Evelyn: Yes, it's a city agency that provides them with financial services; with money; in a debit card ; public assistance; and food stamps SNAPS; so instead of them going to that office; to just apply for SNAPS, they can come here in a loving environment and in less time get the same job done

Tiffany: So what is the difference of going there here? Is it just not knowing that this exists?

All three: yeah people don't know -- unless you do the emergency food stamps -- emergency foods stamps- the only place you can get it is HRA; and you can't get cash assistance here - so if they need public assistance like money - we can't provide that ; you go to HRA for that 38:55
(more HRA talk 41:01) - Friendly customer service

Tiffany: What kind of jobs do you give a lot?

41:05 **Stephanie:** Construction, Security, food handlers, home-helping; so that's like home assistant; home attendant - for like older people to take care of the senior population; the disabled;

Tiffany: Are these all usually hourly paid jobs?

Stephanie: Yes

Chancellor: But it is possible to get a salary

Stephanie: I mean i'm a perfect example-- I got this job because I came here looking for a job (skip)
41:54

43:11 Tiffany: You mentioned the 17 contracts -- is that

Stephanie: I over exaggerated

Tiffany: So those organizations -- is it like REES? What kind of organizations?

Stephanie: Similar; but we have like something called the 10 tracker which is with Food Bank, and it's with 25 organizations; it's a referral network; so we're part of that so other companies and organizations let say need assistance with legal services and they need a legal aid; they'll go to the referral site and be like Oo Restoration has legal aid and send us a referral; referral meaning offering an opportunity or job so they can be placed - so they already have clients that have the potential skill to be hired so when they cross reference and get the referrals, which are the offerings about employment opportunities they are ---

Chancellor: Especially with 10s like Food Banks; there's this church that constantly sends us people
44:41

Stephanie: For the most part we're very successful; we're very persistent too; even with REES i'd be like okay call them again, they don't pick up; okay call them again; leave them a message; okay email * so (looking at Chancellor) He's very persistent -- he's very good with words too so

Tiffany: No cuz, you said "yeah I mean people want jobs, that's why they show up" but looking at the numbers a lot of other places make appointments but they don't show up (emphasizing again why it's so different here and asking again) 45:30

Stephanie: *** I can show you we have a system; we have a PRODUCTIVITY REPORT that we have to do every day and on the status, it says okay make sure you do this; so from 3 to 5 this is what we do, and we're very consistent with that.

Tiffany: Is the productivity report and official thing for you guys to do?

Stephanie: YES; Everyday, EACH PERSON has to do that; and each person is assigned the different days the different duties of what to do; so it's all spread around between the four of us; so like today is my day; I need to make sure I call my referrals, so although I have other things to do, like this meeting, I have you know --- but those are my responsibilities for the day; so those referral calls have to be made so if I know 3 people are from REES, or 10 people from REES, and 10 from Ten, and 2 are from Financial, and 3 are from Employment; whatever it is those people have to be called; and have to be REMINDED; and most of the time they're like thank you so much for calling me, I forgot; oh my god oh yes today! alright I'm gonna come, I'm gonna come, I'm gonna come **** 46:43 - and they come- then we add INCENTIVES too - so when you come for an employment we get you a job and that's the first 20 hours (?) we provide you an unlimited metrocard 46:55 they're like oo I want some of that; now we see if we can get them gift cards; so they want those things; a lot of time they don't have incentives

Chancellor: A lot of times, they don't make those calls. ** I have been -- I've done some of these programs in the city - and I had a scheduled appointment, and it was up to me to remember I had this;

and that's great about us we let you guys know, we are with you, we are a team, you have a goal, you have a dream --- if somebody wants me to succeed (can't hear well, but has to do with genuine care for each other)

Tiffany: Do you think in the other organization you worked in, there were no productivity reports? [48:25](#)

Chancellor: I don't know what they had, but I know -- I was unemployed last year of March 30th, I went to this one program in Brooklyn -- went to an orientation and did everything they asked me to do - I got hired here - I didn't hear from that program until September - I went there in April. And that was just *email*. And it wasn't even an email directly to me, it was just an email blast like hey we have these job offerings -- like guys I've seen you guys in April, you said you were going to contact me, it's September (he knows the struggles of waiting and not being called back)

Tiffany: When you guys call for referrals to the clients, I'm sure there are clients who change their minds and don't want to make appointments and go forward with the next step -- or are there cases like that? If there, are what are the most prevalent reasons?

Stephanie: I'm going to be very honest -- they have had times that clients have said well REES is asking them to do this service; so we know it's about your apartment and they have to come [50:19](#) but basically I have to force them like - they're scared until they come in - and when they come in they see the opportunities, they're like oh we're fine; but it's very rare that has happened -it's very very rare - most people do want to come; most people want the help

Evelyn: (joking) So you do the scare tactic (explaining how it's good they're getting reminded of the help available that way [50:56](#))

Tiffany: You mentioned the biggest problem is that - it's a matter of people just not knowing -- do you have any personal opinions on how these people can encounter the knowledge that these services are available for them better?

Chancellor: I mean Restoration has been stable -- Bed Stuy it's been 50 years -- so that's a huge advantage versus these newer programs (familiarity with Restoration in the community) -- that helps a lot; other than that it's just recruiting and just

Stephanie: Networking -- you know the internet is a big big resource -- there are so many you things you put on social media - you know people run businesses on social media and run multi-million dollar businesses just from social media -- go on fb, instagram, snapchat, all those things that you have -- promote them -- bc most of the time people are home with no jobs on social media. looking up things -- looking up tedious things -- you know put it out there.

Tiffany: But I'm thinking, because if we have a TV at home, we watch commercials, or in a magazine we see ads -- assuming that the population here have different access like you said not all of them have computers or the access that we would think the internet has everything, but if you don't have a computer you don't have that everything; so what kind of hub, whether it's a church, or like what's the hub that these populations have the most access to and could get that knowledge.

Chancellor: It's honest word of mouth -- events -- meeting the face

Evelyn: That's why I'm on the field -- not in the office all the time [56:35](#) on the street, if I have a flyer I'll give it to them; give them numbers -- let them know I referred you - let them help you -- that's how it is just talking with people -- if i'm in the office I can't find a solution

Tiffany: (skip)

Stephanie: Events ** networking - (skip) coming from the Bronx;

Chancellor: * We have banks around here - that literally walks their clients into this office -- financial counseling- we have a great relationship- when they come it we already know what they want -- when they come with the bankers

Stephanie: During tax season, everyday a different banks will be here; so Monday would be TD, Tuesday Citibank; Wednesday would be Chase; Thursday would be Carver. Every day they're here, so if someone comes in they have their taxes and they want to put it in their bank account there's a bank there - telling you about savings and tell you how to --

Chancellor: And then we have just events that happen at Restoration -- Prince party (?) That has nothing to do with Restoration -- it's open to the public run by Spike Lee -- I was there - and people are just coming in asking what these services are - and those flyers that we have ; they used to be on the inside, now we moved them to the outside in the corridor; and where oh there are flyers; just the access to them -- and that's how people notice; I think that is the issue with other programs; like there is a program in Harlem that we work with through the C2C - I never knew about this program -- I never knew about them ; I live in Harlem - didn't know how close these programs were to us; but I knew about Restoration - you put the work in -- you see the results -- other programs say you want more people to know about them - what are you doing about it? how often are you out in the community?

Tiffany: Is there a strategic hub where people gather because of a specific demographic? For example, if there are a lot of religious people in this region, would the most strategic hub that gathers a mass of the community be the church?

Chancellor: It's just Restoration -- 50 years - (skip [1:02:43](#)). Restoration is like central community center